

FOREWORD

LANDS OF ASTRAVIA

WELCOME TO THE LANDS OF ASTRAVIA, THE BEGINNING OF A D&D CAMPAIGN. IN THIS PDF YOU WILL FIND THE basics of the setting. This is yours, interpret it how you desire, read it and discover the lore of the world that is awaiting you. Know that your imagination will be what will fuel the places you'll find. You will forge the story that I'll accompany with all the commitment and care I'll be able to master.

What you'll find in the following pages will be information that your character in one way or another may know. It is up to you whether a character knows more than something else and vice versa. Among these concepts there'll be some guidelines that will allow you to create the hero that you'll embody in your adventures. Pay attention to what I'll present to you but, in case of uncertainties or issues, don't be afraid to discuss them with me.

Know that the following will be the lore I've created with care and specific objectives in mind but will not mean that you won't be able to rectify some minor parts. As I will mention multiple times, this is **our** story, not mine. You are as part of it as the most important characters that you'll meet. You are who'll make my fantasy a story full of intrigues, epic adventures, and whatever you'll ever desire.

I don't expect from everyone to read everything that is written here, but I hope that for the ones interested in it, will find inspiration and will help them to enter the world of Aclorth, and more specifically Astravia, in a more cohesive way.

This PDF is not a way for me to delegate all the information to the reader but it's a way for me to mention things that may not be noticed or regarded as important. You do not have to worry about making notes, because, especially at the start of your journey, information will be fed by me so that you can comfortably enjoy the sessions that await you.

A *tl;dr* of all of this is that I'd love you to at least skim through the second chapter and the fifth chapter to let you understand at least the basics of the world you will be in. But ideally you find the time to read it all. I understand that it is a lengthy PDF, but it will be worth it.

Regardless of the amount of pages you'll go through, I hope you'll have a wonderful time by doing so, and I hope that my effort to portray the world that awaits you is well presented in an understandable manner.

- Your DM, Emanuele aka Zavian aka Lysbeth

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CADENCE OF THE AGES

IN THE BEGINNING, THERE WAS ONLY THE SOUND OF WINGS. FAINT at first, the distant beats were easy to miss. But as time passed they grew stronger and faster, until they could be heard across the great unending dark. Then, with a single flap, creation burst forth: fire, ice, air, water, soil and sky, all came from the sound of feathers that resonated throughout the cosmos. This is the Great Rhythm, and by the Great Rhythm are all things moved. The rhythm tells the sun when to set, and the moons when to rise. The Rhythm tells the seeds when to flower, the trees when to shed their leaves, and the snows when to fall. The essence of everything there is comes from the Great Rhythm.

One day, the Rhythm may call for the end of creation - but there will be no end to the Rhythm itself.

As every downbeat follows an upbeat, so too will the cycles of nature follow their own set pace - for even though the Rhythm can be faint at times, it is everlasting and eternal.

Every denizen of the Sanctum, from the large to the small, from the noble to the poor, knows of the Great Rhythm: the beating force that is the pulse of life itself. The Rhythm started a long long time ago, before all history could be written and our gods walked the earth.

This was the Age of the Forgotten Gods, before our minds came to be.

THE SANCTUM'S MANTLE

One must wonder what it is that pushes us to study history, especially when things are as ancient as the Old World. Scholars or historians clearly didn't understand what they were part of back then, else we'd surely have more to go on... unless the histories told in those times are too horrifying to be told.

The land was not always named Astravia. There is little written of the Earliest Age, and even less on how our Gods rose against their titans that we call the Forgotten Gods. The Father of the Gods has spoken very little about that time, but the little that we know is that the world was chaotic and much larger than what we have and see today.

All know of the chaos built by the titan Aclorth and the creation of all things, how the Plane of Mirrors came to be, and even the Shadowfell and the Feywild.

Their origins are far from mysteries, and will be told in later chapters of this book. But what did the so called Overworld look like? We know that once there was a land of Wind, Stars, Sea, Fire, and of Rocks. That these lands were governed by what our Gods call Primes and that at some point a great battle exploded, a cataclysmic event where the lands broke apart and nature chose for the toll to be paid, a toll in land and people which eventually broke all that we know to be outside of the Sanctum's Mantle.

Our lands, you see, oh dear reader, were named Sanctum's Mantle when the New Gods chose our destiny for us, a destiny not meant for fear and ruin, but one meant for hope and preservation. The Forgotten Gods fought the most passionately during our Gods' uprising and the Faint Divinities chose sides, but

these fights were eventually led by tainted magic and unspeakable acts, so much so that the few that chose the side of hope built a barrier to protect all of Astravia so that one day mortal-kind may be born and live in harmony.

The Forgotten Gods alongside their creator were cast away from our world, in the most distant corners of the Astral and Far realms.

The Uprising was violent but it was necessary for the New Gods to flourish, for the Faint Divinities to find their homes and for the peoples of Astravia to be born under the protection of the Sanctum's Mantle, a place of safety and away from all the terrible cataclysms that are happening every day beyond those magical walls.

Now, it must be noted that this barrier of sorts has not been seen by any mortal, and it is considered a legend more than truth, a story to explain the roundness of our pangea, a way to make the concept of traveling south from Calis all the way to the coasts of the wilderlands as simple as possible while adding mysticism and magic to something so mundane as a sphere that is our globe.

You see, when the New Gods speak of the past, their words are often shrouded in mystery for a sake we have yet to decipher. It's unclear why they would communicate like this with us. Some believe that it is the only way the gods know how to speak, while others believe that the gods simply love to play with us; to see where we take their sometimes insane or unbelievable tales from the past, perhaps in an effort for us not to think too hard on them.

>W< <S THE LAM>

High in the observatories of Tur Del Fur, scholars and wizards dedicate their lives to mapping the cosmos



THE CALENDAR BEGAN FROM WHEN THE AGE OF Enthronement began. Today we're in the year 1342 After Throne, years after the building of the first great nation of Astravia, Avryn. Before then the ages were a bit more of a jumble. At first there was the Earliest Age, or the Age of Darkness, of which we know very little. We know of stars falling from the skies, monsters born and made, and gods growing from nothingness. Then the Age of Anguish, when the New Gods and Faint Divinities were made in the shape of the Primes and made to complete tasks that made little to no sense, to create an order that did not translate. This is when the Overworld existed and the various lands we spoke of earlier existed and thrived, or so we are told. Then the Age of Destiny began, and our Gods made the Sanctum's Mantle. This allowed for nature and magic to slowly stabilize, becoming something simpler to handle. This allowed for life to thrive.

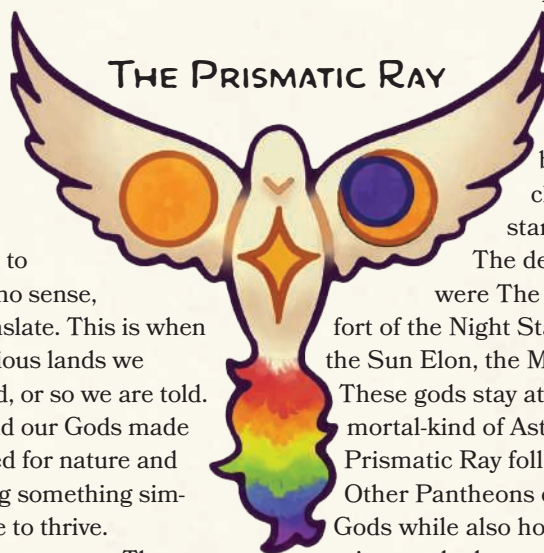
During this age the world was born anew. The continent slowly eroded and the creatures within were born, slowly forming communities, which eventually became settlements and nations. One of these nations is the land you now know as Avryn. It was the first real

state, created under the protection and blessing of the Nyphron Church, which was the first church dedicated to the god-king Nyphron. Eventually, it became the church of Eton. There are some conflicting narratives in history that speak of the Kingdom of Erivan being a much older entity, following the tenets of the Goddess of Elves Ferrol, however these stories have never been confirmed by the dogmas of the church and because of this, the texts herein choose to not take any political stances.

The deities who created the world were The Prismatic Ray, the combined effort of the Night Star Desna, The Songbird Shelyn, the Sun Elon, the Moon Elan, and the Dove Regent.

These gods stay at the base of the beliefs of all mortal-kind of Astravia and the Pantheon of The Prismatic Ray follow and retell these stories.

Other Pantheons exist, some hosting the New Gods while also hosting the Faint Divinities, the minor gods that cover much less broad concepts than the far more powerful and fierce entities that many follow in their day-to-day lives. These topics will be further explored in the following chapters.



NYPHRON'S COVENANT

ГХЗДХЕ ДХ ЛГДХТ

THE NATION OF NYPHRON WAS FOUNDED IN THE YEAR 0 OF our land, named after the Holy King Nyphron, before it became Avryn. The lands of this nation ran from the northern reaches of the wilderlands all the way to the isle of Dacca. Where the eye could see, the influence of the Throne of Light was always palpable. During this time magic was abundant but controlled by the dogmas and vows of Nyphron, the descendant of the New Gods. Tales speak of Nyphron's powers being immense and the Holy King being immortal. A being made of the most rich and rare, and now regrettably forgotten, **Raysium**. Its metal body adorned by gems of pure magic that could channel all powers of all divinities.

As the first true human civilization on this part of the world after the Mantle, the city of Ervanon was founded. It gave rise to a handful of self-entitled noble houses who went on to establish civilization in the name of the Throne of Light—but those who wrote the laws ensured the scales were always tipped in their favor.

Corruption spread through the upper echelons of Ervanon and the great cities that followed. Power-hungry politicians seized each new and valuable resource that was discovered in their bountiful new kingdom. They turned their citizens against each other, forcing them to fight for scraps while they hoarded the King's share. Nyphron was a political war zone. Not only because of the vastness of it, but also because of the various feuds that the noble houses were marching through the streets and the academies that were being built. Whispers of magic beyond the grasp of the Holy King began winding through alleys and candle-lit rooms. Slowly, the people of Nyphron began to create small communities, hidden from the ever-watchful gaze of the alien creature put in charge of all humanity.

In the year 236 A.T., what we now know as the **Arcane Schism** erupted in the streets of the city now known as Manzar. One side stood the Cenzytor family, masters of deep knowledge regarding gods both known and unknown; on the other, the forces of a Holy King who met their defiance with brutal violence.

The conflict was brief but ended with countless deaths at the hands of powers incomprehensible and horrors untold. Yet, from that blood and arcane fire, the nation of Delgos was born, a nation dedicated to breaking all dogmas and all rules for one true goal: to raise humanity above the gods, and to rule itself rather than be ruled by divinities who could never understand the weight of mortality.



RISE OF TESHLO

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AS THE AGES PASSED, SOCIETIES FLOURISHED, THEIR PATH PAVED by the innovations of Delgos. Castles rose in a single day, accelerated by the arcanists' newfound mastery. Even though magic could be used to complete the most difficult tasks with hitherto unknown speed, magic users strove always to innovate. As mages practiced and perfected their powers of creation, they soon unlocked the secrets of life itself, giving birth to wondrous, dangerous new forms of life. These beings were created in the image of the Holy King with the intent to spit his very existence. They were called Raysors, creatures made of Raysium, the same creatures we now know as Clanks.

Yet, with the benefit of hindsight, it is clear that the very magic which allowed mortal-kind to prosper also instilled a deep rot within their civilizations and the Throne of Light. The arcanists of the world grew arrogant and the ones who wouldn't or couldn't wield magics chose lives of mercenary work, or dedicated themselves to greater vows of honor, discipline and of skill. The Cenzyr—once merely a family, now the definition of the arcane elite—came to see their arcane gifts as proof that the gods held no sway over their fate, and that with a sophisticated enough command of magic, they could become as powerful as gods themselves. The Throne of Light and the New Gods looked on in sorrow, hoping their creations would see the error of their ways. The advent of the arcane seemed to be the key to a bountiful age of plenty, but also proved to threaten it, as prosperity soon gave way to greed. Rather than universal goodwill and comfort for all, the **Age of the Arcane** came to be defined by endless petty squabbles over wealth and power among the elite, while the magically inert hunted for their scraps and formed communities to strengthen their numbers.

THE EXUVIATION

Out of spite for these self-proclaimed demigods, a new power stirred to even the playing field. Its name was Novron, a brutal but calculated figure—half man, half dragon—hailing from the deserts of Calis. Politically as powerful as any king, Novron dedicated his life to forming the Order of Teshlor. Under the guidance of the Faint Divinities, he forged seven disciplines of war—techniques now regrettably lost to time, though their echoes remain in the training of every modern paladin, cleric, monk, and fighter. Not much is remembered but it is known that Novron was not keen on letting Cenzyr create its empire on the ashes of the arcane, and so, a war of attrition began from north to south, a conflict that calcified the divide between the sorcerous Cenzyr and the martial Teshlor.

Novron was not only the one who made Teshlor, but also accredited with the birth of dragons how we know them today. His teachings were not only of war, but of alliance, of cooperation between the many magical beings that lived in Astravia in those times. Novron did not literally create dragons but rather welcomed the creatures to live amongst humankind after the Arcane Bound conquered the isle of Dacca, claiming the land held deep connections to their arts.

It was there, in the great city of Percepliquis upon Dacca, that the fighting eventually exploded. A magical calamity of impossible scale shattered the island, twisting it beyond recognition. This ripple effect claimed the lives of many Faint Divinities and ultimately led to the death of the construct King Nyphron himself. In that cataclysm, the magic of the Forgotten Gods was unearthed, the AonDor was opened, and Percepliquis vanished from the maps forever—leaving behind only a fragment of what used to be the almost continent sized isle of Dacca.

Addendum: On the topic of AonDor

If you find the concept of the AonDor confusing, take comfort, you are in good company. It is widely regarded as the physical manifestation of divinity, yet the only library that held the truth of its nature was lost along with the city of Percepliquis.

We speak of it now not because we understand it, but because we cannot tell the history of this era without it. Until the Divide separated mankind from the elves, the pursuit of the AonDor was the invisible current pulling civilization forward. It is a locked door in the hallway of history; we may not have the key, but we must acknowledge the door exists.



TOWER OF AVEMPARTHA
HOME OF THE FIRST MAGE ESRAHADDON

COINS OF TREASON

While the north burned with the fires of arcane discovery and then with the rush for understanding of the AonDor and its properties, the southern coasts of the Nyphron Empire began to rot from within.

After the death of Nyphron himself the efforts to survive for his empire became more and more relentless. The kingdom of Delgos was humbled by the terrible events of the isle of Dacca but still held knowledge and power over the arcane. The Holy Empire was no longer holy but it did what it could to maintain its influence over the known lands. The AonDor was powerful enough to silence even the Prismatic Ray. Ever since it was unleashed, the crusades began for whoever controlled that power would surely have become the next super power of Astravia, and the rush toward it was monumental.

The people of Ervanon began to amass wealth from their vassals to explore the, back then, unexplored areas of the north now that the arcane was much more important to humankind. The north contained valuable resources but also hosted a number of magical creatures that slumbered and hid from mortals, a slumber that was awakened by the clash of steel and the prayers of clerics who wielded the words of the fallen Throne of Light.

This crusade was not cheap, however, and the tithe came from the south, which was the richest and most developed area of the empire. Tithes were raised. Then doubled. Then tripled. The Church claimed these funds were necessary to secure the Sanctum's Mantle and protect the faithful, but the merchant princes of the coast saw only their coffers emptying into a war that offered them no profit.

The breaking point came with the discovery of a second AonDor near the northern cliffs. The Church immediately seized the land, which led to a rush for this new divine power that was as frantic as any gold rush, a rush that was expensive and difficult to the common folk, especially the ones far from this conflict.

Led by the shrewd King of Galeannon, and eventually by the isolationist people of Rochelle and the guild masters of Vernes they did not raise armies; they simply closed their ledgers. Shipments of grain, people and gold to the capital ceased. Mercenaries hired by the Empire suddenly found their contracts bought out by anonymous benefactors. In a matter of weeks, the Holy Army found itself starving and unpaid. It was a silent war, fought with embargoes instead of swords. Nyphron found itself stretched thin by its conflicts in the north against the ever growing threat of monsters, Delgos, and now the Elves who claimed ownership on all AonDors. It could not afford a civil war on its own soil. And so, in the year 412 A.T. the **Treaty of Coin** was signed. The southern provinces

declared their independence, forming the Plutocracy of Calis. They would remain the trade hub of the continent, supplying all sides of future conflicts, for a price. In exchange, they paid a tithe of respect to the church, a nominal fee to save face for the now falling empire, while keeping their true power firmly in the hands of those who held gold.

LOCK AND KEY

After the second AonDor was found, a new rush began. The nation of Delgos, ever hungry for arcane power, clashed with the people of Erivan who were alerted by the cataclysm. The history of this era is murky, with sources from Delgos and Nyphron constantly contradicting one another. Yet one truth remains: the Elven forces were far superior.

Their mastery of the arcane revealed a ruthless method of warfare, indifferent to death. The Elves possessed a terrifying, ageless vitality that not even the most powerful sorcerers or paladins could extinguish.

It is in this period of time that the magical beasts of war were created by the clerics of Nyphron. Now that their god was gone, their now abominable magic that created what were called Gilarabrywn, creatures capable of matching the immortality of elves. When the first beasts appeared in the battlefields Delgos quickly retreated leaving the battle between the scarred holy empire and the immortal elven people.

This was called the **War of Residue**, named after the strange and even now incomprehensible substances left by these god-defying spells being used between the two forces.

The war raged for centuries, with the Gilarabrywns outliving their owners and wreaking havoc to the north. Without oversight from their owners the Gilarabrywns triggered the AonDor, though these events are still shrouded in mystery. This new blast destroyed countless lives and forced an abrupt end to the conflict in the year 712 AT.

Quickly after these events both mortal and elven-kind realized that the AonDor was not a prize but perhaps a cruel test by the gods to see how quickly creation could destroy itself. A treaty was made, known as **The Divide**, to make sure that the last known AonDor, found within the mountains of Erivan, was never to be activated. The holy empire was forced to give up the knowledge of the Gilarabrywn and give up their desire for power. This was the death knell of the Empire. It divided into two new countries: Trent, a coalition of survivors hardened by the war who were sworn to defend the north; then Avryn, which was a pale shadow of its former glory. The great city of Ervanon collapsed under the weight of its failure, and the capital was moved to Melengar, marking the start of a humble, bitter new age: The Age of Nations.



TRENT

wilderlands

ERIVAN

elvenlands

AVRYN

ALBURN

CALIS

Melengar

Warric

Rhenydd

Maranon

Tierre

Ghent

Dunmore

Galeannon

Dagastan Bay

GOBLIN SEA

GHAZEL SEA

Archipelago

Gur Em



CHAPTER II

SHARDS OF MANTLE

THE SECOND CHAPTER OF THIS TOME DELVES INTO THE COM-
plex and fascinating world of Astravia, exploring
geography, politics and society of all the nations
of mortal-kind. The social tapestry, political intrigues
and struggles of each people will be much clearer after
reading through this chapter. Keep close attention to
the aside notes, especially if your interest lies in the
important people who shape today's political and eco-
nomic milestones.

This chapter is the base of all that is to follow, such as
religions, organizations and general knowledge on the
world. Our goal with what we find in this chapter is to
give guidance to someone who has not had a chance
to explore the world of Astravia on their own.

THE WORLD OF ASTRAVIA

The world is divided into four regions.
The main one being the central area
of the pangea being the four mortal
kingdoms of Avryn, Calis, Delgos,
and Trent.

The second part of the world is
dedicated to the unexplored lands
beyond our countries. These are
usually referred as the westerlins to the
west and the wilderlands to the north.
Understand that people the people of
Astravia have been quite busy in the past
millennium and haven't had the chance to fully
explore what the world has to offer. Many explorers
have tried their luck beyond the volcanic areas of
The Sound and never returned, while exploring south
of the Ghazel and Sharon seas requires preparations
that have yet to be met, against perpetual storms and
dangerous magical events that make exploration a far
more difficult profession than one might expect.
To the south there is the Isle of Dacca which, as men-
tioned earlier in the tome, used to be a much larger
piece of the land. Dacca is surrounded by dangerous
sea and sky creatures and is a difficult land to observe
given the terrible magical storms that surround its
high cliffs.
Finally, to the east the kingdom of Erivan, or the elven
lands, sit behind the great Divide, a large river that
is not only a geographical divide between the mortal
and immortal kingdoms, but also the subject of a pact
that still exists to this day, making it a physical border
against war and conflict with the elves.

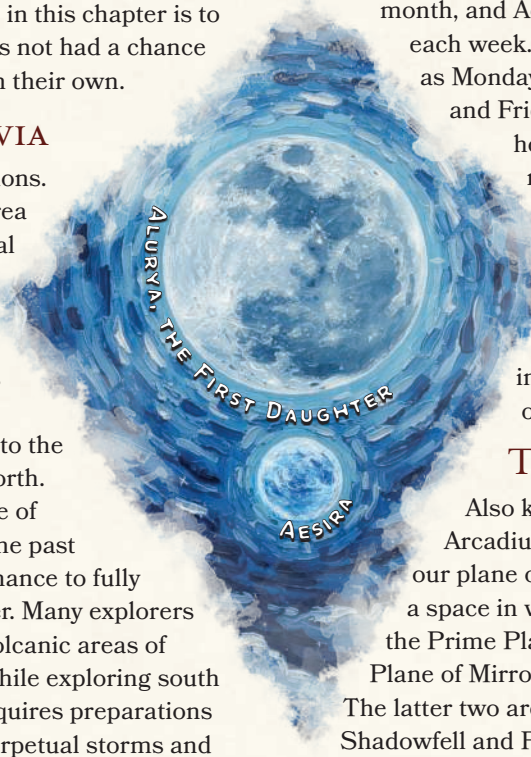
THE CALENDAR

Although we would find it difficult to understand
if you didn't know of these rules, it is important to
always present the whole truth. The world of Astravia
revolves around 12 months of 25 days each. Each
five days makes a week of three days of duty and two
days of dally. Each day is illuminated by the light of
our sun Eton, and each night is cradled by the gaze of
two moons: Alurya, the larger, and Aesira, her young-
er sister. Alurya has a 25 day cycle, indicating each
month, and Aesira has a 5 day cycle indicating
each week. The days of the week are known
as Monday, Tuesday, Wednesday, Thursday
and Friday and each day is made of 24
hours. Each hour is made of 60
minutes and each minute is made
of 60 seconds, and so all the
devices made by the League of
Miracles and the various clock-
work guilds are made in the
same fashion. To time keep is as
important as to know how to read
or how to speak.

THE ARCADIUM

Also known as the Planescape, the
Arcadium is anything that is beyond
our plane of existence. Imagine a plane as
a space in which beings live. We all live in
the Prime Plane and we're surrounded by the
Plane of Mirrors, of Shadows and of Twilights.
The latter two are also known respectively as
Shadowfell and Feywild.

Beyond the four fundamental planes there is the
Ethereal which is engulfed in elemental and magical
essences. The Arcadium is structured in an hourglass
shape, with the top being The Hallows Above and bot-
tom being The Underscape. The Hallows Above is said
to be the home of the New Gods. The Underscape has
been claimed by demons, devils and other monstrous
creatures. According to the gods, the Prime Plane
is protected by an invisible wall that makes passing
from and to the outside of the four fundamentals
much harder and much less convenient than any other
magic. More details about the Arcadium will be found
in later chapters.





Avryn, The Shattered Throne NOUN: AVRYNIAN(S)

NOTABLE FIGURES

The following are key public figures in the region.



SCION LORD ESSENDON AMRATH ESSENDON

King Amrath is the latest of the family Essendon. At age 36 is the youngest king of the country, and aims to maintain a rule of justice and balance between the various noble houses.



QUEEN GALFREY ESSENDON

The devout Queen Galfrey, of Ervanon, is the wife of the Scion Lord and has made sure that the values of the Nyphron Church were still maintained in Avryn and the whole of Astravia.



COUNTESS VALESKA RHENYDD

The last descendant of the family Rhenydd, Valeska is the fierce leader of Ratibor. She has been throughout her life a fierce and capable leader who has maintained its independence towards the crown while still following its dogmas and directions.

Once one of the greatest human empires in Astravia, Avryn has declined significantly in power and influence over the past few centuries. When Nyphron died, Avryn slowly collapsed into social upheaval and, shortly thereafter, civil war. Seeing an opportunity to seize power from chaos in the year 735 A.T., House Thrune, which has long practiced the dark arts of diabolism in secret, entered into an open pact with the powers of Hell. Backed by legions of devils, and the house's own armies, House Thrune stamped out its enemies and claimed the former Throne of Light. Following its victory, House Thrune ushered in sweeping changes, reshaping Avryn into an empire that eventually broke its people yet again, this time under the rule of a blood-fueled family rather than an ever-knowing magical construct. At the time in Avryn the official histories were little more than state-sanctioned propaganda, the government running a merciless and labyrinthine bureaucracy which eventually led to the loss of many important documents and the death of multiple long standing families that hailed from the age of the Throne of Light. The rule of Thrune aimed at elevating the ruthless and crushing the weak, and the once-white roses of Glamrendor, from that age onwards, became blossoming fields of luxurious, velvety black blossoms.

Yet, for all its insistence on discipline and authority, House Thrune's rule has not gone unchallenged. The city of Colnora, in particular, has long been home to subdued dissent and underworld corruption, and from it came Corvin Essendon who grew to become a ruthless and bloody general who eventually led a war against the diabolist throne, the **War of Iron and Thorns**. This civil war led to countless battles and deaths but eventually allowed the family Essendon to take the throne from House Thrune in the year 1134A.T. and ever since, the Essendon family has been the banner of righteousness against the powers of Hell. This brings us to today, where King Amrath Essendon rules a country divided from its holy roots and has the difficult task of creating trust between the people under his rule.

In Colnora the corruption of the underworld became stronger and stronger by the decade, eventually birthing the cunning and ruthless shadow organization named the Black Diamond, a group of thieves, assassins, and mercenaries which hands now reach the pockets of powerful noble houses and trade routes creating even more instability for the fairly young monarchy. After the civil war King Corvin divided the country into five counties which went under the control of the five noble houses that existed at the time. Notably Warric was then created later in the country's history.



PATRIARCH GRAVES

The Patriarch of the Nyphron Church, Venlin Graves, is one of the most powerful entities of Astravia despite the fall of the church during the War of Residue. His domain has made sure that the authority of the church would be respected in all mortal-kind's settlements.



PRINCESS REGENT ARISTA

A figure of enigmatic power, leader of Rochelle and of Alburn.



THE SIBILANT ITCH

A Gilarabrywn, hailing from the War of Residue, the creature roams the south eastern side of the country. Although not actively aggressive, the people have grown wary of its territory and stayed as far away as possible from the seemingly immortal dragon.



BAREK VOLHYNT

The current maintainer of Ratibor's Narrows, the largest mega project of Astravia that did not involve the work of the League of Miracles.

The Volhynt family has led the effort for over four centuries and remained at the center of one of the most incredible feats of engineering of the current age.

ALBURN

Led by Lady Arista, Alburn is the magical center of the country, having its capital set in the dazzling city of Rochelle.

People looking for a life full of intrigue or perhaps looking for a connection to the spiritual will find plenty to do and to discover in Alburn, where neutrality is the most respected trait to any and all people. Its leadership is as mysterious as the many masked galas held in its beautiful capital.

DUNMORE

The breadbasket of Avryn, Dunmore is a region whose patrons are one of the older noble families of the country. The Dunmore have seen families rise and fall, regents be killed and reign supreme. Where history was written a member of the Dunmore family was always behind it, following orders and ensuring the sovereignty of the Empire would always remain under the control of a wise and capable ruler.

The capital, Glamrendor, houses one of the oldest castles of the country, built by the very League of Miracles from the Age of Arcane. Dalgren on the other hand is a much more recent addition to the county. The village was constructed around the mysterious relic of ancient times, the Mage Tower of Avempartha. It has become a center of attention for many adventurers who want to be the first to find the meaning of the tower of the First Mage, and the secrets it holds.

GHENT

Here the history of Avryn lies within dusty tomes and within minds that are now long gone. Ghent's capital, Ervanon, was once home of the Throne of Light and is now the center of the Nyphron Church, the religious power who serves the dogmas and rules of Nyphron, a power that still to this day reaches all the corners of Astravia.

MELENGAR

The current center of the leadership of the country. Here you will find the city of Medford, as well as many other settlements, which hold the surviving noble houses that were born under the rule of House Thrune. Melengar is a place not only defined by a turbulent history and a legacy that challenges the very existence of Ervanon but also is a battlefield for all the most powerful political entities of Astravia, a place where wars of decrees, words and secrets are constantly fought between the most powerful.

RHENYDD

Hailing from the most prolific war council of Avryn, Rhenydd holds the crown of the oldest and most powerful family, alongside Dunmore. However, while the breadbasket held the power of trade, Rhenydd held and still holds the power of the army and of the most renowned lawmakers of the continent.

Its capital is the fortress Ratibor, which has held its ground ever since its creation before the fall of the Throne of Light. Rhenydd has gained the respect of powerful warlords and trade princes alike within Astravia and still maintains an iron grip on any dealings it participates in.

WARRIC

The youngest county of Avryn, Warric is an independent region which fought to be still a member of the empire but to maintain its sovereignty and its status of republic within its capital Colnora.

Warric is the center of trade in the country and maintains an order that is unmatched within its trade routes that connect to both Delgos and its magical academies, and influenced by Calisii trade of mercenaries and unique cultures.



SABLEWOOD

Found between Dunmore and Alburn, the Sablewood is an ancient, expansive forest also known as the "Endless Verdance". The trees reach hundreds of feet into the air, creating a canopy so thick that travelers often cannot distinguish day from night. The soil is notoriously dark and fertile. The forest is rumoured to be older than the Forgotten Gods, making it the first seed of creation in Astravia. Often, the hints of proof of this found within the woods tend to confirm this fact in stark truths, rather than just being an exaggerated legend.

The area of the Sablewood is found just south of Avempartha and it contains the most unique and rare flora and fauna of the continent. The inhabitants of the forest, also known as Hybrid Faunt, are animals that are almost always a blend of two familiar beasts or animals and elements. They range from docile to territorial and are often larger than expected due to profoundly long lives.

Many believe that due to the magical connection of the woods, this place contains primordial beings who have never been able to survive or leave the forest, creating a mystic and mysterious location filled with secrets and connections not only to druidism and the most ancient of magics, but also to the most ephemeral concepts of religion and godhood.

Two centuries ago the woods have become impossible to traverse, and only very few individuals have claimed and proved they have survived the harsh woods that constantly try to make their travelers lose their tracks and lose themselves within its labyrinthine roots. Moreover, many believe this location to be connected to the inner shards of the Arcadium, some indicating a lot of similarities to the Plane of Twilight. Others think that the place is the breeding grounds of Faint Divinities or, more worryingly, a place from which the agents of chaos of the Forgotten Gods find hidden entrances and pathways to our plane of existence.

THE DIVIDE

To the majority of Astravians, the Divide is simply known as the pact that was brokered between mortal-kind and elven-kind when the War of Residue ended, however Avrynians know that it is also the name of the eastern river which divides Avryn and Erivan, a stark reminder of the natural laws of humankind to never, under any circumstance, cross it and explore the elven-lands.

For nearly seven centuries, the pact has dictated that if mortal-kind were to ever cross the Divide, it would be an act of war against the immortal elves. Mortals know all too well that within the elven-lands is the last known location of an AonDor, however that fact has never been confirmed due to the fear of causing another bloody war against beings who are seemingly unkillable.

Many stories and fables tell of the thousand years old elves that know and remember all from the times of the first and second AonDors, and to challenge those memories is to challenge the arcane powers of all elven-kind, something that is far from preferable, especially given the instability of the various kingdoms and their very tumultuous pasts.

Calis, The Golden Road

NOUN: CALIS/CALISII



NOTABLE FIGURES

The following are key public figures in the region



PACTBROKER HASHIM IBN SAYYID

While the Pactmasters rule Dagastan absolutely, their desires are implemented by the Pactbroker, making him the effective ruler of the capital.



MALDUONI, KEEPER OF THE FIRST LAW

Wildly popular and elected to an unprecedented fourth term, Malduoni has made sure that the power of Vernes remained unmatched among all other trade cities.



TRIETTA RICIA

The popular scientist-duchess of Vernes honed her zeal for invention and cheerful demeanor while studying the notes of the city's founder

The vast deserts of Astravia's southern coast may look inhospitable, but it was here along their rugged shorelines and fertile rivers that human civilization first rebounded from the devastation of the first AonDor.

For thousands of years, before the Throne of Light was founded, humanity huddled in small bands and villages, eking out a bare existence under an ash-clouded sky, rarely organizing beyond localized trade networks. Then came what we now know as the Calis Imperium, clever artificers who rose from the deserts of what is now Dagastan. The Imperium conquered the neighboring peoples and forced the dwellers of the now known Avryn in central Astravia to form a defensive federation to stop the ever-growing power of the Imperium. With the rise of the powerful Throne of Light, however, the Imperium fell and all became one nation. But Nyphron's Covenant eventually met its end as well, finally collapsing under the weight of its own hubris. Agents from an ancient land which was swallowed by the AonDor, called Qadiran, took advantage of this decline. These agents destabilized the region until they could sweep in and "rescue" the church from disaster, returning the power to the Calis Imperium.

Today the nations, collectively dubbed the Golden Road, are a study in contrast. In their bustling, cosmopolitan cities, markets overflow with curiosities from across Astravia, while scholars advance the frontiers of magic and science in buildings older than many northern houses. Yet at the same time, settlements remain largely restricted to coasts and rivers, leaving huge stretches of land untouched, ceded to deadly monsters and those bold adventurers willing to brave them. In these sun-drenched dunes ruled by scorpions, genies, fiends, and sphinxes, heroes find their fortunes—or are swallowed forever.

THE BARRIER WALL

The mountains of the Barrier Wall run across Galeannon, separating the deserts of Calis from the lush lands of Avryn. Difficult to reach and almost impassable, the Barrier Wall contains only a few scattered settlements, one of which being the gilded Vernes, the Golden Gate of the continent, dividing the riches of Calis from the decadence of Avryn. The vast majority of the range remains largely uninhabited, home only to some of the most remote adventuring locations on the continent. Most notable among these is the ruins of Kho, what is known to be the first and only flying city that made it out of the clutches of the AonDor. Among its rubble mortal-kind battles over priceless sites including the Fields of Glass, the Domes of the Polymatum and the Pit of Endless Night and many more lesser known sites.

ECONOMICS

Despite the presence of productive mines and other natural resources, most of the Golden Road's economic power comes from trade. In Galeannon and Gur Em, this is largely due to geographical and political factors, the result of being endpoints of major continental trade routes. The primary export of Calis is magical knowledge and rare antiquities, as well as clever machines and incomparable engineers, but it must also import major quantities of food.

The desert dwelling settlements of Rolandue and Wesbanen, while self-sufficient, still lean on the lucrative sun orchid elixirs for their statuses as major players on the world stage.

PESH

The euphoric drug known as pesh comes from the milk of a cactus of the same name, originally native only to the mysterious lands of Qadira. The drug has several different forms, but the most valuable—and hence the most commonly smuggled version abroad—is the refined form. This is a tarry, chunky black paste made by cooking the cactus's milk along with its resin and other additives. When eaten or smoked, the drug gives users a sense of well-being, sometimes combined with hallucinations, though these can also turn to paranoia, aggression, and exhaustion. It's also dangerously addictive, as its dealers know all too well.

DAGASTAN

Dagastan is a city dedicated to trade and little else. Its bazaars are known across Astravia not just for their size, but for their incredible (and sometimes immoral) variety of wares. No item is too rare or taboo to be found somewhere in the tents, shops, and wagons of the city's merchants: magical reagents, forbidden spells, holy relics, and deadly poisons. In Dagastan, those with gold make the rules, and the only question is whether one can afford their desires.

The founding of the city is shrouded in mystery. Many believe that survivors from the ruins of Kho traveled south in search of their now lost land, and instead of despairing when they realized that their ancestral land was now destroyed they chose to build something that no one ever saw in Astravia, wondrous and magical and an affront to the works of the League of Miracles of Delgos. Rumors speak that many of the most powerful of the country are secretly dragons in the guise of mortals that lived through the times of the Teshlor and the reign of Novron, however these rumors were never confirmed.

VERNES

Vernes boasts some of the finest—and oldest—buildings and monuments on Astravia. Over nearly a millennium, Vernes has been built, rebuilt and rebuilt again, resulting in a tapestry of architectural styles as diverse as the countless citizens and visitors who throng its streets and markets. Nearly a dozen districts huddle within the city's walls, each as large or larger than some capitals of other nations, and each with numerous neighborhoods and intrigues tempting to both common residents and thrill-seeking adventurers alike.

ASCENDANT COURT

Within Vernes, the Throne of Light used its divine power to erect the Starstone Cathedral, a bewildering, ever-changing series of trapped passages and confounding chambers meant to thwart anyone who might follow in his footsteps. The cathedral holds enormous, ostentatious temples to the Prismatic Ray, flanked by lesser churches and shrines dedicated to forgotten faint deities.

Pactmasters

While it is a strange way of governing people, the way of Plutocracy, which is to form a government of the wealthiest and most powerful people in the country, is much less autocratic than one might believe at first.

Dagastan holds a great number of Pactmasters, people that are put in charge of the political and economical wellbeing of the country. Due to the importance of these roles and the importance of these people's riches, their identities are kept completely secret and not even the Pactbroker truly knows who is in these prestigious positions.

A PACTMASTER IS IMPOSSIBLE TO RECOGNIZE, EVEN TO THEIR LOVED ONES



SUN ORCHID ELIXIR
WHEN DRANK, YOU PHYSICALLY BECOME
AS YOU WERE IN YOUR PAST

THE OASIS

The conglomerate of Rolandue and Wesbanen are also most commonly known as the Oasis of Calis, founded before Dagastan became the power that it is today and made under a single principle: let no mortal be beholden to a god. This ideology was proposed by the philosopher Kalim Onaku as a way to end the Oath Wars that were plaguing the deserts during the dominion of the Throne of Light. This principle quickly expanded into a governing manifesto dubbed the **Laws of Mortality**. In the eyes of the Calisii of the area, religion is a form of indentured servitude—the sale of one's immortal soul. Worse, faith encourages violence and division between mortals while blinding believers to reason. Though often labeled as atheists, the dwellers of the Oasis do not doubt the existence of the gods—rather, they reject the idea of worship, seeing the gods as powerful and capricious aristocrats who use mortals as toys. In the dwellers' minds it's better to live in freedom, with all the hardship it entails, than to spend eternity as a thrall.

All forms of deity worship are outlawed in the Oasis. Possession of holy texts or symbols can result in heavy fines or exile, while preaching within its borders is punished by imprisonment or worse. With the exception of clerics and others who channel the gods' powers, religious visitors are still welcome to trade in the incredibly secure and defended roads that pass through the region. Additionally all people of all beliefs are also welcome to come and study in the region's esteemed universities, so long as they do not proselytize or conduct religious rituals while there. Immigration is also encouraged, with the roadside propagandists welcoming with song all those willing to "reject and rejoice". Faiths that resemble religion but do not venerate divine beings are viewed with suspicion but tolerated—notably the faiths of druidic origins, since many druids hired by the government present one of the best tools for the rapid accelerating urbanization of the region.

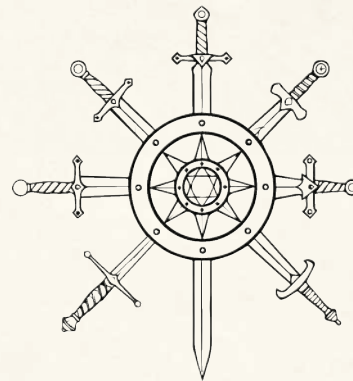
Enforcement of the laws governing religion falls to the Pure Legion, a sophisticated military organization based out of an unconquerable fortress called Shepperd's Rock high in the canyons of the Gur Em desert.

A council of representatives from the major Calisii settlements and nomadic groups rules the Oasis, voting every 5 years to appoint one of its members as Pactmaster of Dagastan to maintain independence and a fruitful collaboration between the modern take on life of Vernes and the strict rule of Dagastan.

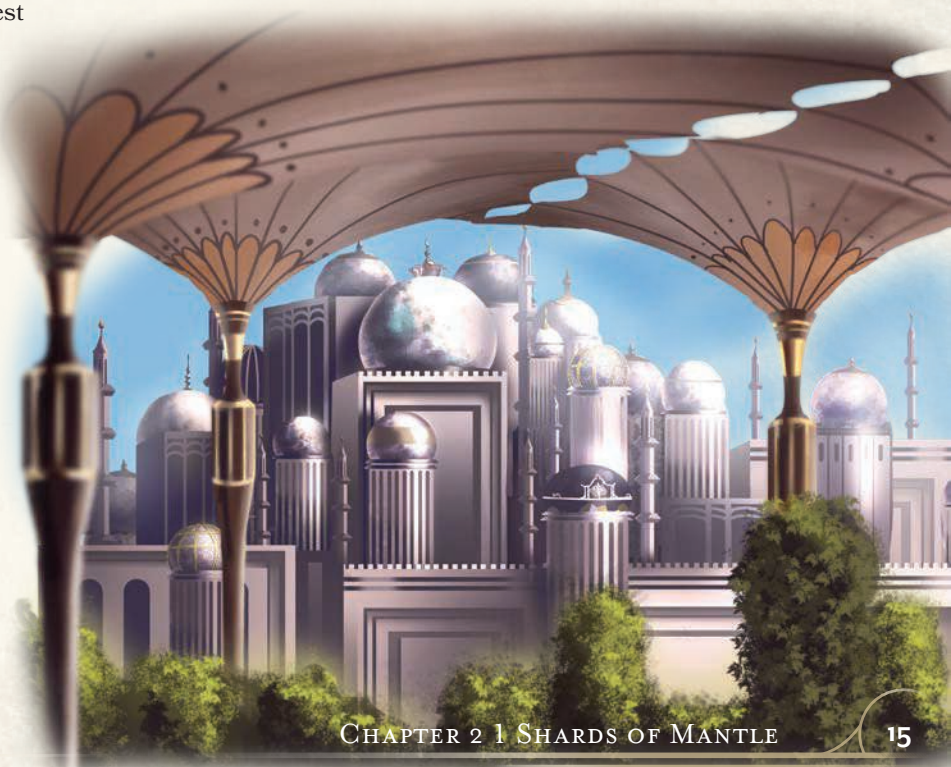
THE VANISHING OF NOVRON

Not long after the end of the War of Residue Novron and its disciples of Teshlor disappeared without leaving any traces. No one knows the true reason as to why this happened but unfortunately after this the Calisii have forgotten the ancient techniques of the Teshlor.

Obviously this did not stop them from becoming a very powerful force in Astravia through their disciplines and exotic way of fighting, mostly due to the different weaponry such as their unique curved swords. One has to wonder, however, what has happened to these extremely prolific people and how or what kind of magic has made it so that no one would remember the power and capability of Novron and his disciples.



THE ONLY PHYSICAL PROOF OF
TESHLOR'S EXISTENCE IS THEIR
EMBLEM



Delgos, The Impossible Lands NOUN: DELGAN(S)



NOTABLE FIGURES

The following are key public figures in the region.



KHARSWAN

Thakur Kharswan, the smiling ruler of Delgos, must balance obligations between all the people under his rule and the League of Miracles.



MANZAR CENZYLOR

The immortal archmage Manzar vanished so long ago during the events of the AonDor that he is more legend than man to the citizens of the county that bears his name.



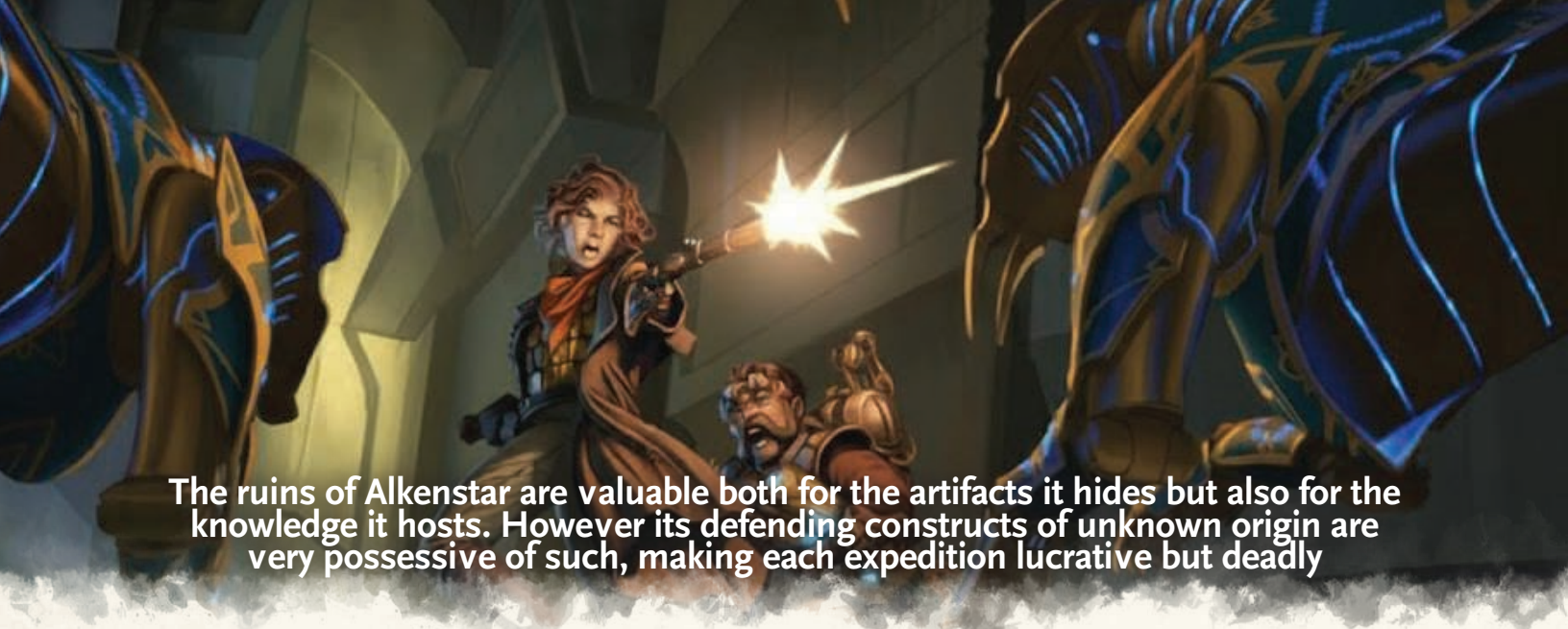
LADY-MAYOR SABRIYYA KALMERALM

When Manzar's previous lord-mayor died under mysterious circumstances, townsfolk elected this silver-tongued merchant, who also happens to be a prolific member of the League of Miracles, scandalizing the city's nobles.

The independent kingdom of Delgos often referred as the so-called Impossible Lands trace its history back to the foundation of the Throne of Light. Even today the region's sparkling cities, breathtaking monuments, and arcane accomplishments seem rooted in some distant epoch when miracles were commonplace and legendary monsters walked alongside heroes bound for grand destinies. It is believed that in prehistoric times, the region fell under the domain of a vast cyclopean empire, whose megalithic ruins and broad, half-buried causeways hint at a grandeur seldom matched in the present day. Long before the AonDor toppled these monuments and reduced their builders into scattered, survivalist masses, armies of the god-king Nyphron established cities and colonies amid the ruins of these fantastical places, making both Manzar and Tur Del Fur beautiful cities for everyone to behold.

The history of the Impossible Lands has been dominated by two wizard-kings, Fur and Manzar. The two kings clashed for centuries in a devastating arcane war that warped the fabric of the country itself. The most obvious scar of this conflict is the twisted wasteland that still can be seen in the borders between Tierre and Maranon, a gnarled landscape of magic-warped terrain ravaged by occasional arcane storms known as the Mana Wastes. From nightmare beasts born of the Fleshforges of Manzar to the countless undead making up the populace of Fur, the region remains stained with the hubris of these two mages, and the thought of their lands once having been free from their terrible actions seems more fable than fact to the people caught in their wake.

Despite this tumultuous history, the realms of Delgos count themselves as the mightiest and most fantastical realms in all the lands of Astravia. Manzar, who remains one of the most powerful and influential archmages Astravia has ever known, second only to Esrahaddon, set the archetype for the Impossible Lands. With the creation of vast networks of magic that make transportation almost instantaneous it is difficult to imagine a world where the Throne of Light wins against the unsurmountable raw power that Delgos has shown and still shows to this day. Manzar's hated enemy, the equally ancient ghost necromancer Fur, ruled a cosmopolitan prosperous nation that would be considered among Astravia's wealthiest and most promising kingdoms, if not for the fact that now, as the nation calls itself Tierre. Unfortunately most of its inhabitants outside of the magical fortifications are undead monstrosities who willingly follow their baleful leader into eternity to serve his dark designs forever. Ever since the events of the AonDor both Manzar and Fur have gone missing, supposedly because they were in Percepliquis when the cataclysm exploded.



The ruins of Alkenstar are valuable both for the artifacts it hides but also for the knowledge it hosts. However its defending constructs of unknown origin are very possessive of such, making each expedition lucrative but deadly

ALKENSTAR

The arcane wars between Manzar and Fur were not kind to the surrounding regions, often reducing their captured territories to blasted wastelands where warped radiation prevented all magic from functioning. The depths of Alkenstar, also known as the Fallen Star in Delgan dialect, arose in such a place, created out of the sheer arcane concentration that this place stored. Though the mages had abandoned their wars long ago, Alkenstar has become a ruin not too dissimilar to Trent, a place of magical creatures and sentient weapons which only remain here as ghosts rather than anything else. Now a layer of the same material of the War of Residue covers most of Alkenstar's brick-and-iron buildings, but elegant brass decorations shining through the grime hint at the grand architecture beneath. Voluminous clouds of steam hang over the city and sometimes cover its streets, mixing with the thick fog banks that cover most of its built roads. It is one of the most expensive projects of the League of Miracles to make sure that these clouds do not permeate the ground these ruins lay beneath.

The reason why magic manifested a city of incredible dangers and treasures is still a question which keeps historians and students awake at night. Equally haunting is what was found within the ruins: weapons that only the most renowned metallurgists and engineers could fathom, firearms capable of delivering devastating outcomes. It makes it even more strange the fact that these weapons, although rare, all have one thing in common: they talk and manipulate their owners to do their bidding for a cause that noone has managed to decipher.

MANZAR

The city itself is situated within beautiful salt canyons that give the city its pink sunsets and dawns and gives its people the ability to be a strong contender in the economical world. Manzar is a city built on trade and industry, created by the ingenuity of the incredible League of Miracles, which creates wonders with the flick of a wrist. They accomplished this and continue to maintain the city by summoning mighty spellwrought adranachs, capable of lifting thousand-pound bricks of limestone into the sky to rebuild walls, towers or even castles in a matter of days.. Many of the league's spellwrights have become folk heroes and celebrities for their miraculous acts, which range from healing those maimed in fights to transmuting raw timber, mud, and straw into full fledged houses in minutes.

TUR DEL FUR

The land of Fur is a fortress built to withstand any and all attacks from sea, sky and land. The castle like capital is the center of magical research of not only Delgos but also the entire continent of Astravia. The academics of magic call this their home and dedicate their lives to the study of The Arcadium and to the theorizing of what truly happened with the AonDors that were activated so long ago and what was the fate of the magical Sky City of Percepliquis.



VARIOUS SHAPES
AND SIZES
OF ADRANACHS



Trent, the Broken Lands NOUN: TRENTISH

NOTABLE FIGURES

The following are key public figures in the region.



QUEEN ANASTASIA

One of the most powerful wizards to rule in Astravia, descendant of Baba Yaga's bloodline, Anastasia hopes to sculpt Trent into a haven for exiles from across the world.



RUNELADY SORSHEN

While Sorshen hails from a mysterious origin, she has adapted to her new role as runelady with grace, offering help on more esoteric magics.



GOLD KING MENGKARE

The Gilarabrywn Mengkare freely offers both his hoard and his wisdom to the members of the independent community of The Tethered, people who have submitted to his rule.

Scarcity defines the Broken Lands. The terrain is mostly nonarable, the cities small and scattered, the people hard and fiercely self-sufficient. Survival is a constant battle that leaves little time for less pressing concerns. Cities in this region lack the prestigious artistic, academic, and cultural institutions that the empires to the south enjoy, but they also lack the extreme inequality and social rigidity that can hobble advancement in those lands. Here, a person's fate is in their own hands, and destiny is for the bold to forge.

Both natural climate and historical disasters have shaped this nation. The rocky, wind-scoured canyons of the east and the paranoia-infested magical forests to the west are impossible to cultivate, while the mosquito-infested western borders to the wilderlands and the monster infested central lands are even less hospitable. Arable farmland in the region is limited to the eastern conglomerate of Lingard and the only exportable good is the whisperwood found among the mushroom stalks which live in the shadows of the inactive volcanoes of the western forests.

The region's history has unfurled against, and continues to be guided by, this backdrop of scarcity. Centuries ago, the AonDor devastated most of the countryside and, centuries later a Rain of Stars enriched the canyons of Trent not only with mystic and magical metals but, more importantly, monstrous and eldritch creatures which made the area even less favorable to mortal life. When this event erupted within the region and spewed fiends from the far reaches of the Astral Plane, southern nations sent soldiers and supplies northward to bolster the ever-changing war against the elements, but when the worst of it came to pass and new threats arose closer to home, those nations pulled their support away. Now, though the gravest danger has been sealed off, countless otherworldly creatures and their corruptions remain scattered across the central canyons, and few stand ready to face them.

Wild, perilous, and largely uncharted, the Broken Lands are filled with dangers and mysteries both ancient and modern. Civilization is a fragile thing here, and in the vastness of the woods and lakes and windswept tundra, spirits and stranger things rule. However, this is not just a place of pain, but also a land of magic and wonder, an enchanted place where winter is constant, wild animals can talk, and mysterious spell-casters known as the winter witches rule the wilds. The stories of Trent's sagas are told to children by parents as parables—they must mind their elders and be good, lest the winter witches snatch them away and feed them to their true leader, the legendary Queen of Witches: Baba Yaga. In the case of Trent, these childhood fairy tales are even more accurate than one might think.



ETERNAL WINTER

It is believed that the first AonDor's cataclysm was so apparent and so devastating because of the sheer power that the Cenzytor wielded at that time and because that was the first time that such energies were released in the Prime Plane. The second AonDor was far less apparent but it still caused terrible consequences to the northern regions of Astravia. However, despite popular beliefs, the Eternal Winter is not one of those consequences. Instead the main consequences were the appearance of powerful creatures who are believed to be from different planes. Baba Yaga is one of these creatures, who chose to subjugate the Broken Lands under her curse, which after just 21 days blanketed all of Trent into a never-ending winter. Baba Yaga, however, did not linger after her triumph. As if the act of cursing mortal-kind was all that mattered, she left her domain in the hands of one of her daughters, a cruel witch who was promised eternal youth in return for keeping the nation safe and secure for her kind. Every 100 years, though, Baba Yaga returned to reclaim the ruling queen, taking that daughter away to accompany her on her journeys to other Arcadiums and leaving a new daughter installed on the throne.

After 6 queens, this pattern collapsed. The seventh ruling daughter was a woman named Elvanna, said to be the most cruel of a long line of cruel queens. As the time of Baba Yaga's return drew near, Elvanna grew more and more convinced that she deserved to remain Trent's ruler forever. When her mother arrived, Elvanna triggered a devious trap and captured Baba Yaga, then turned her magic toward spreading the curse of winter to other lands. Only the timely intervention of a band of heroes halted her plot, freed Baba Yaga, and saw Elvanna's defeat. Today, for the first time since its founding, Trent is ruled by someone other than a winter witch, yet this should not necessarily be taken as a hopeful sign. Queen Anastasia may be young, but as a descendant of the same bloodline of her ancient grandmother Baba Yaga, she has the potential to wield great power. Just how she will choose to exert this power in her stewardship over Trent has yet to be unveiled. Certainly, Trent is no safer a place today than it has been for centuries, and with rumbles of embittered witches who regard Queen Anastasia as the "Fraud Queen", it remains to be seen if her rule will match the almost century-long reigns of her seven aunts.

Today, Trent remains in the grip of unending ice and snow. With the disappearance of Baba Yaga, the hopes of cleansing this never-ending curse from the land are slim and difficult to maintain. As such, the land remains eternally frozen, with frost goblins, winter wolves, ice trolls, and all manner of rime-coated fiends and eldritch creatures posing common threats to those who have little other choice but not to keep their heads low and their minds focused on simply making it one day at a time. That the first few years of Queen Anastasia's rule have resulted in less agony for the land's citizens is not taken as indication of a blissful future. Life in the Broken Lands has always been tough, and many still feel the new queen's kindness is a cruel trick intended to grant hope only to rip it away just as the citizens start to trust again. And beyond the dissidents and spurned witch relations of the prior ruling castes plotting intrigue and fomenting rebellion, there is always the threat to the east of Lingard—memories of the War of Residue still linger there, and with an untested queen on the throne, it may be only a matter of a few months before a new war begins.

RUNELORDS

When Trent was founded, its leaders hoped to create a nation free from the excesses and elitism of the Cenzytor. This dream was dashed when the runelords assassinated the noble families placed in control of Trent and took over before Baba Yaga's arrival. Though the title of runelord has passed between many individuals throughout history, the present ones are simply

experts at magic and are the recipients of countless generations of knowledge on the eldritch, arcane, infernal, and mystic arts.

To meet a runelord or runelady is to meet the personification of countless centuries of refinement of the magic arts, giving them incredible power both political and magical. A runelord or lady must never be displeased lest you summon their wrath and their countless hexes and curses.

The High Seas

NOTABLE FIGURES

The following are key public figures in the region.



AMARANTHINE COUNCIL

The leaders of the Mordant Spire are mysterious and secretive even with their own people, issuing cryptic orders that their followers must puzzle out.



HURRICANE QUEEN JAKALYN

Wildly popular with ordinary pirates, the new Hurricane Queen nevertheless makes some of the other Free Captains nervous with her recklessness.



THE OPALESCENT SOVEREIGN SYLANDRI

The draconic creature lives within the storms of the southern seas, terrorizing all explorers and pirates that dare pushing their luck towards her territory, deep within the ruins of Percepliquis.

The southern seas of Astravia are rough and lawless places. Controlled by no nation, the Astravian Ocean teems with pirates and raiders, from the Free Captains of the Shackles to the dragon-headed long-ships of the Ba Ran Ghazel.

The eastern coastlines are in a perpetual bloody game of cat-and-mouse between Calisii and Ghazel's fleets and the central coastlines of Avryn, Calis, and Delgos are often plagued by "accidents" and attacks that do not cause wars but cause difficulties between each nation's trade ledgers.

Most nations with a coastline have some sort of navy, but a few stand out as particularly noteworthy. Constantly at each other's throats, Avryn and Delgos have the two largest fleets, their warships forever harassing each other but keeping just short of actions that would tip them into outright war. Once an equally formidable power, the Calisii navy has only recently being rebuilt after dwindling for several decades, though it still runs a legendary shipyard that can build a warship in a single week.

To the south the abolitionist Free Captains guard the depths of Dacca's destruction rich of artifacts alien to all people of Astravia. Since the first AonDor, crossing the Astravian Ocean has been considered madness by many Inner Sea residents. Tales of bold adventurers raiding the shattered isles of Dacca for the fantastic treasures lingering in its half-drowned ruins have been staples of storytellers since Novron first led the very few survivors of the cataclysm.

In recent years, news of state-sponsored overseas colonies have begun capturing popular imagination. Still, for most sailors in the region, the Astravian Ocean might as well represent the southern edge of the world. The vast majority of traders never leave sight of land—and those who do are often persuaded of their folly by merfolk, sea devils, brine dragons, and other predators of the deep ocean.

EYE OF PERCEPLIQUIS

The death of Nyphron during the events of the first AonDor wracked Astravia physically and culturally, yet perhaps no evidence of his passing is so great as the massive, terrifying storm that sprang in the Dagastan Bay. Now a stationary, seemingly permanent hurricane, the Eye of Percepliquis lashed the Ghazel Sea's southern coast, drowning the Calisii and Delgan coastlines. The middle of the Eye is plagued by the Mordant Spire, controlled by the mysterious and dangerous Amaranthine Council.

THE SHACKLES

With the appearance of the Eye of Percepliquis trade along the southern coasts became much more difficult, and the pirates were forced to band together to survive. United under the first Hurricane King, the newly named Free Captains of the Shackles became a single fleet, their actions guided by the Pirate Council—pirate lords powerful enough to each control one of the sea's major hidden ports. In addition to its usual raiding, the new fleet sold its services to Delgos, Calis, and Avryn, promising to secure trades and to sell the locations of mordant spires scattered throughout the ocean in exchange for tribute.

The Shackles themselves are as chaotic as one might expect, with each port having its own laws and customs. Many have tried to map them out, but often times those map makers were found dead in a ditch or drowned in the deepest reaches of the ocean, making the whole topic quite taboo between explorer leagues. It is known, however, that by far the largest community is known as Port Peril, situated somewhere in the Dagastan Bay, guarded by the cannons of Fort Hazard on the cliffs overlooking the seas below.

BAR RAN GHAZEL

Noone knows of how the Ghazel came to be. A race of brutish humanoids made of decaying flesh and speaking a language impossible to decipher. Many believe that the Ghazel are nothing else but the personification of the terrible consequences of the AonDor on mortal-kind, however what is truth and understood by everyone is that these creatures are monsters by the very definition of it.

The creatures have made it nigh impossible to explore south of Astravia and to the east of Erivan, as their vessels, albeit primitive looking, are fast and capable of keeping up with the fastest Calisii and Delgan ships. Their methods are brutal and destructive and it is understood that if a ship meets a Ghazel by sea, prayers and cries of agony will fill the air.

THE YELLOW CITY, MALAKOR'S DEN

Hidden within the high seas it is believed that a city of yellow banners lives within the ever-shifting mists. Some believe them to be ghost or sailor stories, but others swear that within the southern edges of Astravia a magical city houses a mysterious otherworldly entity that goes by the name of Malakor. The creature's name has been whispered throughout the decades and strange coins showing the silhouette of a displacer beast have been found in the midst of investigations of deaths of high politicians and economists. Displacer beasts are rare and difficult to track down creatures only found in the Calisii deserts.

The mordant spire is a conglomerate of eldritch curses and hexes, making it almost impossible to infiltrate unbeknownst to the Amaranthine Council

REFRACTIONS OF ARCANES

MAGIC IN ASTRAVIA IS EXPRESSED IN MANY DIFFERENT WAYS, FROM TYPES AND SCHOOLS OF MAGIC TO MAGICAL TRADITIONS AND RITUAL magic. Magic theory academically explores the nature of magic, and subjects in metaphysics touch on many underlying forces.

The magical traditions are split into Arcane, Divine, Occult and Primal magics, while the schools of magic are divided in Abjuration, Conjunction, Divination, Enchantment, Evocation, Illusion, Necromancy, and Transmutation. However, many of the techniques studied by contemporary academies tend to focus on the results of magics rather than their base functionalities, making schools of magic and magical traditions more of the base foundations of magic and the results being what it is truly acted upon.

Magic is something that is a very personal thing to each creature in Astravia. To some it is a calculated act with no chance at error while to others is more felt like a river: guided and channeled but never fully controlled. In this chapter we will not touch in too much detail in the various arcane basics as that is a duty of the various academies of the world but we will touch on the current understanding of the Arcadium as well as gathering information for how to recognize more abstract concepts such as the AonDor, Raysium, Whisperwood, and the manifestation of magic in Forging.

AONDOR

As we've mentioned countless times within this tome, the AonDor is something that has driven peoples throughout history and has created opportunities, allowed pacts, and has been in the center of conspiracies and revolutionary ideas.

It is difficult to put into words what an AonDor is, let alone what it looks like, however the general idea is that the AonDor is literally a portal or an opening through which pure and raw magic passes through.

Many believe that these are energies from the Forgotten Gods, summoned in an effort to undermine or hurt the New Gods in an act of revenge or some other mysterious reason. Others believe that these are representations of the powers that elven-kind can attain through studies and powerful rituals that aim at undermining the fickle unity that mortal-kind has managed to achieve during the last millennium. What is usually shared between the various schools of thought is that AonDors are Fragments of Divinity, small representations of what a god's power might look like if brought into reality. The history written about the Throne of Light is slim at best, however many believe that at the time magic was wildly more chaotic than nowadays.

One thing is certain, however. The AonDor is the cause of terrible things that have happened in our combined pasts, and as such, it cannot be overstated how important it is to avoid all opportunities to interact with such unstable energies. The consequences of the utilization of magics of the AonDor are ever-present in our societies and one has just to ask to any scholar and they'll be told plenty of tales of the terrible powers of these rifts in reality.

On the topic on how they look like, this is a mystery that has yet to be unveiled. A lot believe that some fragments of crystallized AonDor were gathered and harvested during the War of Residue, however these are just rumors and have no real representation in the texts and proofs that we have had throughout history.



THE ARCADIUM

Also known as the Planescape, the Arcadium is something that has been the study of many scholars and academics. It is an ever-evolving field which studies otherworldly locations, but there are a few concepts that have remained the same for quite some time. It must be said, however, that most of the information that will be found in this chapter is theoretical but ever since the events of the War of Iron and Thorns in Avryn the interest towards the cosmos outside of ours has been growing steadily. Many of the studies were found through the exploration of the Alkenstar in Delgos and through the further understanding of Cenzylor's notes.

The Planescape's Diagram is often represented in an hourglass shape. In the middle are the Fundamental Planes, those being the Prime or Material plane, the Plane of Mirrors, of Shadows and of Twilights, the latter two also known respectively as Shadowfell and Feywild. The entire center of the hourglass is surrounded by a thick veil known as the Ethereal Plane that is imbued with the various fundamental natural elements of Earth, Fire, Water, and Air. Then there is the above that is known as the Hallows Above and the below that is known as The Underscape. There are a fair amount of other planes that don't fit anywhere in particular and are described as follows:

- Limbo, the plane of supreme chaos
- Mechanus, the plane of supreme order
- The Far Realm(s), the plane of madness
- The Astral Plane, the plane of eternal
- The Plane of Dreams, or dream world
- The Plane of Mirages, from where illusion is made
- The Plane of Light, from which ideas are born
- The Plane of Magic
- The Plane of Time

Throughout this chapter we will do our best to give the basic information that is known about each plane of existence and their nature. Do note that, in the effort to maintain transparency the following pages will contain many excerpts of what Cenzylor, and sometimes Fur, have written in their notes and the narrative voice of this tome will most likely change. We will add asides and small notes in case things are particularly unclear or still up to debate.



The Center of the Multiverse

It's usually upsetting to Prime Material bashers when they hear that their little world isn't in the center of the universe, which is why they're known to planars as the Clueless. Many understand that there's no particular center to the planar Multiverse. Rather, it all depends on where you stand. Folks in Sigil see the City of Doors as the center of the multiverse, folks of the Prime Material Plane say their own worlds are the center of the universe, and the efreet brag that the City of Brass is the center of all. The thing is, maybe they're all right and maybe they're all wrong.

The multiverse, being infinite by most standards, no matter where you stand, that's the center of all things. The Signers have turned that idea into a whole philosophy: "I'm always at the center of the multiverse; therefore, I must be the center of all universes"

In blunt words, the fact is there ain't any place in the whole multiverse that's more important than any other, and their "centers" are usually defined by their usefulness.

The Rule of Threes

"Good things come in threes," they say. Well, so do bad things. Either way, the number 3's important—some say it's got power. Things out here tend to happen in threes, like Prime Material, Inner and Outer Planes; Good, Evil, and Neutrality; Law, Chaos and Neutrality. See two things and ask, "Where's the third?"

The Grand Design

Now that philosophy is out of the way, the next question is, "How does the whole multiverse fit together?" Well, that depends on who gets asked. A bleaker will say there ain't no scheme, while a Godsmen will go on about innate celestial glory and the like. None of them will answer the question straight. Maybe the best thing to do is to get a hold of the Guvners and ask them (fact is, their answer's no better than anyone else's, but they like to put things into nicely defined categories, and at least they'll give a clear picture). Their answer would go something like this: "There's three basic divisions of the multiverse: the Prime Material Plane, the Inner Planes, and the Outer Planes. Although they're all connected to each other in a variety of ways, it's easiest to picture each as separate from others.



This is the beginning of one of the best preserved journals of Cenzytor. Many believe that what he talks about, Sigil, is a city that can be found somewhere in the Planescape. Most believe, through interpretation of his texts, that it is found somewhere in the Ethereal Plane and is somewhat a connection bridge that makes it possible to get to all other planes.

It is widely understood that there is also a Rule of Sevens, but that is mostly found in the teachings of Baba Yaga.

We chose to add this mostly for the sake of the argument that the texts of Cenzytor are nebulous at best. What is written is often difficult to understand and up to interpretation, even today. Because of this, please take text within these excerpts with a grain of salt when trying to understand the complexity of what lies beyond the Sancum's Mantle.

Shown is also a heavily interpreted schematic of the Planescape, however what is presented in the previous page is what is widely agreed upon to be the de facto shape of the Arcadium.

THE FUNDAMENTAL SHELL

Directly echoing our world are the Fundamental Planes. These are not distant realms, but rather twisted reflections of Astravia, occupying the same space but vibrating at a different frequency.

- **The Plane of Twilights** (Feywild): A realm of unrestrained life and emotion. Here, the sun is eternally setting in a kaleidoscope of colors, and the laws of nature are dictated by the whims of the Archfey. It is a place of dangerous beauty, where a memory can be traded for a song, and time flows like syrup: sticky and inconsistent.
- **The Plane of Shadows** (Shadowfell): The dark mirror to the Feywild. It is a colorless drain on the spirit, a monochrome wasteland where emotions are dulled and dead linger. It is not inherently evil, but it is inherently *heavy*. Gravity, memory, and despair all weigh a little more here.
- **The Plane of Mirrors** (Ever-changing Maze): Situated "beneath" the material geometry, this is a crystalline labyrinth of exact opposites. It is said that for every action taken in the Prime, a reaction occurs here. It is a realm of hard edges, refracting light, and doppelgangers. To walk the Maze is to face the truths you refuse to acknowledge about yourself, reflected in infinite facets.
- **The Elemental Planes:** A bit further away than the first three, the elemental planes of Earth, Fire, Water, and Air are all enshrouded within the Ethereal Plane. These are planes of chaos, but are classified as such only because we don't understand them. To get to the elemental planes is to have a direct specific goal in mind, as one does not go to these places without having a reason to do so.
- **The Ethereal Plane:** Understood to be the "center" of the hourglass, it is a shroud that hides us and all fundamental planes, allowing passage but still maintaining secrecy as thick as fog. Beyond here, all knowledge is theoretical and not much is known.

The Outer Planes

The Outer Planes collectively are the largest area, at least according to most planars. Primes and elementals tend to disagree, but they just don't want to acknowledge the glory of these realms. The Outer Planes are the home of The Powers, deities who for some reason take interest in the lives of mortals. Out here can be found gods, demigods, and fiends, along with petitioners, planars, and a host of other creatures.

Each plane is its own universe. Some have limits, others are infinite. Each plane is linked to those adjacent to it by fixed gates—folks call the path between them the Great Road. With a map to the gates, a body can travel the entire chamber of either the Hallows Above or the Underscape. 'Course, that's provided the fiends don't get them first...

While the Outer Planes have physical barriers to prevent them to bleed into the Prime Plane and the chambers of the Hourglass; Limbo, Mechanus, Astral and Far Realm, are planes that easily bleed into the Fundamental Shell allowing no proper force to control it or to divide it. The same goes with the lesser planes such as the Dream, Time, and so on.

Here's a good piece of advice: The Lower Planes are the site of the ever-raging Blood War, the lawless conflict that's raged for eternity between tanar'ri and the baatezu. They're not places the foolish can pass through alive.



The student of planes is one who dedicates their entire lives just to know what awaits us beyond the stars



THE METAPHYSICAL SANDS

Beyond the immediate reflection of the physical world lie the planes of concept—the "Sands" that fill the bulb of the Hourglass. These are not places of land and sea, but of raw, manifest ideas.

- **The Plane of Dreams or Dream World:** A shifting ocean of the collective unconscious. This is where the minds of mortal-kind go when they sleep, birthing temporary pockets of reality. It is also the graveyard of forgotten memories. Secrets that are lost to history do not vanish; they sink to the bottom of the Dream World, waiting for a brave enough diver to retrieve them.
- **The Plane of Magic, the Void:** The raw, churning engine of creation. Here, magic is not a force to be channeled but an atmosphere to be breathed. It is a place of violent storms and impossible geometry, where magic exists in its purest, most volatile form. To enter the Void unprotected is to risk being unmade, your very existence unraveled into raw spellstuff.
- **The Plane of Mirages:** The birthplace of illusion and deceit. In this endless, shifting expanse, nothing is real, yet everything can hurt you. It is the realm of "What Could Be", a testing ground where the mind's resilience is pitted against its own desires. It is said that the most powerful illusionists do not create images; they simply open a window to this plane.
- **The Enlightened Oasis:** Often mistaken for the home of the gods, this is actually the plane of Inspiration. It is a blinding white expanse where ideas are born. Every invention, every revolution, and every work of art in Astravia, in one way or another, began as a spark in the Oasis, before finding its way to the a mortal's mind.

THE ENDS OF TIME

Finally, at the chaotic extremes of the Hourglass, lie the planes of finality.

- **The Hallows Above:** The top of the glass, where the sand comes from. A realm of order, hierarchy, and the blinding brilliance of the New Gods. It is a place of absolutes, where morality is objective and unyielding.
- **The Underscape:** The bottom of the glass, where the sand eventually settles. It is the realm of entropy and lower vibration, home to demons, devils, and the discards of creation. It is usually considered as the source of many of Astravia's greatest threats.
- **The Plane of Time, the Oblivion:** The glass itself. A theoretical plane where all moments—past, present and future—exist simultaneously. It is not a river, but a solid ocean. To step into the Oblivion is to be assaulted by every moment of your life happening at once. Only the most ancient entities, or those completely unmoored from causality, can survive here without their minds shattering under the weight of eternity.



THE CONSTELLATIONS OF THE BELOW: THE UNDERSCAPE

The Underscape is where the coarsest, heaviest sands eventually settle. Knowledge of these realms is fragmented, largely destroyed during the fall of House Thrune or locked away in the mad scribbles of Cenzytor. What remains are not maps, but warnings—spectral observations of realms where the laws of nature bow to the laws of suffering.

- **The Pit of Law:** Scholars describe this not as chaotic fire, but as a chillingly perfect bureaucracy of pain. Telescopic enchantments directed at this “lower frequency” of reality reveal a rigid, descending hierarchy. It is theorized to be a place where tyranny is absolute, a reversed mountain where the weight of the strong eternally crushes the weak. It is the cold, mathematical perfection of evil. It is also known as Hell.
- **The Endless Hunger:** If Pit of Law is structure, the Endless Hunger is a wound. It appears to observers as a swirling void of entropy that defies the cosmic order. It is believed to be infinite, a cancerous layer of the planescape that exists solely to consume the others. Those who study it too closely often go mad, claiming that this abyss is not a place, but a living, hungry entity that screams in a billion different voices. It is also referred as the Abyss.
- **The Plane of Nightmares:** Often confused with the randomness of Limbo, the plane also known as Acheron is observed as the plane of conflict. It is the final destination for spirits who died with hate in their hearts. Remote scrying suggests a realm of floating iron cubes crashing into one another in an infinite, metallic void. It is the nightmare of soldiers: a war without a cause, a battle without a victory, simply the eternal clash of steel against steel.
- **The Gray Waste and The Prison:** These planes are difficult to distinguish, appearing as a vast, gloaming nebula of despair. The Gray Waste, also known as Hades, is theorized to be the death of passion—a gray wasteland where color and emotion fade into nothingness. The Prison, also known as Carceri, often viewed as its neighbor or perhaps its core, is the planescape’s penitentiary. It is whispered that the gods do not send sinners here; rather, the weight of one’s own treachery acts as a gravitational anchor, pulling the soul down into Carceri’s inescapable chains.

THE ZENITH: THE HALLOWS ABOVE

Looking “upward” in the metaphysical sense is blinding. The Hallows Above are bathed in such intense conceptual light that they are difficult to analyze. To the mortal mind, a place of perfect good is as alien and terrifying as a place of perfect evil. They are the “Stars” of the Arcadium, guiding lights that are unreachable by mere feet.

- **Mount Celestia, the Silver Step:** The most visible of the upper constellations, Celestia appears in religious texts as a singular, infinite mountain rising from a silver sea. It represents the concept of Ascension. It is the physical manifestation of the idea that one can always be better. It is believed that the geometry of this plane forces a constant climb, where the air gets thinner and the truths get harder the higher one goes.
- **The Unbound:** Little is known about this plane, also known as Elysium, for it resists definition. It is a plane of the “Good” that does not require “Law”. Theoretical arcanists posit that Elysium is a realm of perfect rest and untroubled existence, a paradise that demands nothing of its inhabitants. It is the silence after the song, the peace after the war. Because it lacks conflict, it is almost invisible to divination magics, appearing only as a warm, golden static.
- **Arcadia and Bytopia, the Ordered Gardens:** To Celestia’s mountain these are its valleys. They are observed as realms of perfect harmony between nature and civilization. In Arcadia, the trees are rumored to grow in perfect rows, and the seasons change with the precision of a clock. In Bytopia, industry and nature work in a symbiotic loop. They represent the ideal society, the community that works.
- **Arborea and Ysgard, the Passionate Wilds:** On the fringes of the Hallows lie the realms of chaotic good. Arborea is the emotional opposite as the Gray Waste, a place of overwhelming passion, art, emotion, where the weather shifts with the mood of its divinities. Ysgard is the celestial reflection of glory; a place where valor is the only currency, and battles are fought not for land or hate, but for the sheer joy of the struggle.

RAYSIUM

A lost magical material from the times of the Throne of Light, Raysium is what it is believed to be the base material from which all Clanks are made of. The fact of it being lost is why it is almost impossible to find a Clank that was made in recent times and the only other sources are from the Alkenstar. It was usually described as a bright golden metal, so light it was almost white.

Many believe, through legends and retellings of the ancient times of Nyphron that Raysium is also the physical form of magic, and many believe that in one way or another Raysium allowed for the true creation (and destruction) of sorcerers.

WHISPERWOOD

Sourced from the ancient, silent forests bordering the elven-lands near the conglomerate of Lingard, Whisperwood is a timber of rare and mystical properties. To the eye, it is a pale, almost luminous wood, with a grain that seems to shift and swirl like smoke.

Whisperwood is unnaturally light, yet stronger than oak, and when carved, it emits no sound, absorbing the noise of the tool against its surface. Its most prized quality, however, is its supernatural resonance to magic. Instruments crafted from Whisperwood produce notes of unparalleled clarity and haunting beauty. Many artificers understand that Whisperwood has a natural affinity for enchantment magic: it can be used both as a catalyst and a tool to detect magic.

The Runelords and the witches of Trent keep this material close to their chests, suggesting to artificers of Astravia that Whisperwood is more magical than it is already understood.

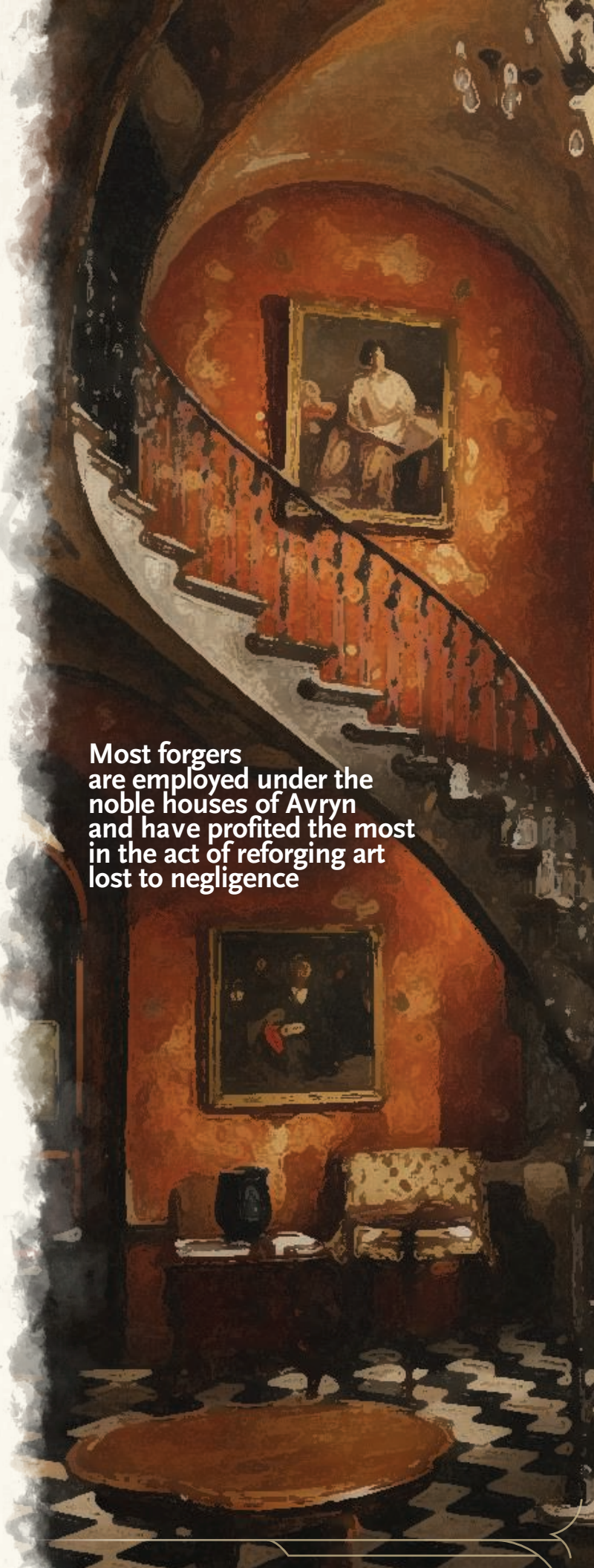
FORGING

"All things exist in three Realms. Physical, Cognitive, Spiritual. The physical is what we feel, what is before us. The Cognitive is how an object is viewed and how it views itself. The Spiritual Realm contains the object's soul—its essence—as well as the ways it is connected to the things and people around it.

Forgery is a fairly recent technique that involves shaping a specific form in order to evoke some sort of extra-normal event.

For example one can forge a table's essence or history to have been cared for rather than neglected, or reforging an Awakened object to have a different command phrase.

The main reason as to why we mention this fairly niche technique mostly found within the borders of Avryn is because it has been brought to our attention that these eccentric artists have reported finding within the residue of their incantations traces of Raysium, suggesting that perhaps the Clank race is not hopeless in its existence.

A painting of a room with a spiral staircase, a checkered floor, and two framed portraits. The room has a warm, orange-brown color palette. The staircase is on the right side of the frame, leading upwards. The floor is checkered. There are two framed portraits on the wall. One is on the upper level, and the other is on the lower level. The painting is done in a style that is somewhat abstract and expressive, with visible brushstrokes and a sense of depth.

Most forgers
are employed under the
noble houses of Avryn
and have profited the most
in the act of reforging art
lost to negligence

CHAPTER IV

ECHOES OF DIVINE

TO SPEAK OF THE DIVINE IN ASTRAVIA IS TO SPEAK OF A SHATTERED mirror. High above, the Prismatic Ray—the architects of the Sanctum's Mantle—shine with a unified, blinding light. Eton, Elan, and their kin represent the cosmic order, the Rhythm that binds the universe together. But down here, in the mud and the stone, the light fractures.

For the common folk, the Prismatic Ray is distant, a cosmic concept. Instead, the people of Astravia turn to the Echoes—the Faint Divinities, who walk closer to the struggles of mortality. In the fervent cathedrals of Avryn, prayers are sung to Maribor and Abadar, architects of civilization and law. In the dust-riddled libraries of Delgos, the turn of pages is a hymn to Nethys and Brigh, the gods of unbridled creation and invention and metallurgy. In the wild heart of Trent, faith is a matter of survival, offered to Muriel for life or Gorum for the strength to keep it.

This chapter explores the spiritual landscape of our world, from the ancient, ancestral worship of the Seldarine in the forbidden lands of Erivan to the forbidden whispers of the Shadows of AonDor that lurk in the dark corners of history. Here, we do not merely list names and domains; we seek to understand why a merchant in Calis fears the same god that a tyrant in Avryn worships, and how the silence of the Forgotten Gods speaks louder than the thunder of the new. While the Prismatic Ray serves as the spiritual bedrock for much of Astravia, the nations have naturally gravitated towards what they call "Faint Divinities". Each divinity, be it high or being faint usually has a distinct representation to them, perhaps a holy symbol, a title, but, most importantly, a domain to which they abide to.

It is unknown whether the divinities served their domains since their inception or if mortal-kind in one way or another put these labels on the gods and they simply obliged. However the facts still don't change and usually a devotee of whatever god they choose knows at the very least what their god represents. It is rare to find someone that knows of all the Faint Divinities, especially because it must be noted that the number presented here is not a full list. Instead this is a list of the most well known divinities and what is known about their acolytes. The faint divinities, as we've said, walk closer to mortal-kind's struggles and as such there might be some divinities that have perhaps as little as a family that follows them.

The main pantheons that exist around Astravia are the following:

The Prismatic Ray, also known as the High Gods. These are the five deities that are considered the architects of the Sanctum's Mantle. They are rarely petitioned for mundane tasks, instead representing the cosmic balance of the Rhythm. The following deities are part of it: Eton, Father of the Gods; Elan, Mother of the Gods; Desna, The Night Star; Shelyn, The Songbird; and Nocticula, The Redeemer Queen.

The Nyphron Covenants, also known of the Gods of Civilization and the Legacy of Men. Its worship is centered around Maribor, the Third Son, while respecting the legalistic frameworks of his subordinates. Part of it are: Maribor, God of Men; Abadar, Master of the Vault; Irori, Master of Masters. Due to the relatively recent disappearance of House Thrune and its still strong influence towards various noble houses many consider the devil Asmodeus, The Dark Whisper part of the same covenant.

The Arcane Accord, also known as the first Engineers. Part of this pantheon are: Drome, God of the Forge; Nethys, The All-Seeing; and Brigh, The Whisper in Bronze.

The Green Pact, the divinities dedicated to survival and the primordial wilds: Muriel, Goddess of Nature; Gozreh, The Storm-Born; Gorum, Our Lord in Iron; and who is known as the Beast of Winter, god of Entropy. Finally, many acolytes of the cult of Baba Yaga and various people that have come in contact with the spawn of the AonDor of Trent consider the demon Lamashtu, The Mother of Monsters, also a member of the pact.

The Seldarine, the ancient gods of elven-kind. Not much is known, but words always spread of the gods Ferrol, god of Elves; Yuelral, The Wise; and Keteplys, The Hunter. Predominantly these are elven divinities and are always recognized as such.

CULTS OF SHADOW

Not much will be written about these, but many people all around the continent of Astravia have gathered around three faint divinities who have plagued many historical local events in various counties, these being the cult of Uberlin, the God of Darkness; Yog-Sothoth, the Key and the Gate; and Nyarlathotep, the Crawling Chaos.



The Night Star



Mother of Gods



Father of Gods



The Songbird



The Redeemer Queen

THE PRISMATIC RAY: ARCHITECTS OF THE MANTLE

To speak of the Prismatic Ray is to speak of the fundamental machinery of existence, glossed over with the comforting veneer of divinity. It is a pantheon not bound by blood, but by a shared cosmic purpose. The architects of the Sanctum's Mantle are fivefold, a coalition of distinct, primordial forces that united to maintain the delicate equilibrium between the searing light of creation and the crushing weight of the void. They are the refraction of the cosmos into understandable concepts; if the universe is a song, as the Great Rhythm suggests, then the Prismatic Ray are the notes that compose it. They do not demand blood sacrifices or constant wars in their names. Instead, they demand that mortals simply live—that they create, dream, love, and endure. For in the act of living, the people of Astravia strengthen the Mantle that protects them all. Some people see the Prismatic Ray as the Aesira, a common word which means in ancient Astravian as "The First Ones".

At the zenith of this order stand Eton and Elan, the binary heartbeat of the world. Eton, the Father of Gods, is the manifestation of the Sun and the Downbeat of the Great Rhythm. He is the unyielding structure, the blinding truth that banishes shadows and dictates the march of time. He represents the "Sanctum"—the walls, the protection, the physical laws that say a stone must fall and a fire must burn. Still, a drum cannot beat only once.

Elan, the Mother, rises as the Upbeat to his Downbeat. She is the Moon and the Earth, the gravity that grounds us and the silence that gives meaning to the sound. She is the "Mantle", the nurturing soil and the comfort of the hearth, the gentle hand that ensures that while Eton's sun may scorch, her earth will always provide shelter. Together, they are the Cycle—the promise that the sun will rise, the tides will turn, and the seasons will change.

Yet, a house built only of stone and law is cold without the warmth of experience. While Eton and Elan provide the stage, it is the three Goddesses of the Triune Heart—Desna, Shelyn, and Noctricula—who give the performance its soul. These are not children of the Cycle, but ancient, independent entities who joined the Ray to imbue mortal life with color, passion, and agency.

Desna, the Night Star, claims the darkness that Eton leaves behind. She is the ancient voyager, the spark of hope in the obsidian sky that reminds mortals that the dark is not to be feared, but explored. She teaches that luck is simply preparation meeting opportunity, and she guards the sanctity of the Dream, protecting the sleeping mind from the horrors of the Underscape. Walking hand-in-hand with her is Shelyn, the Songbird. As the goddess of art, beauty, and love, she is the argument that survival is insufficient without meaning. Shelyn represents the joy of existence, the painting on the canvas and the melody in the air, acting as the spiritual glue that binds communities together through shared expression.

Completing the pantheon is the enigmatic Noctricula, the Redeemer Queen. Unlike her peers, she was not born of the celestial lights but ascended from the shadows to join them. She represents the Midnight—not as a time of fear, but as a threshold of transition and second chances. As the patron of exiles, the marginalized, and the artist of the macabre, she stands as the eternal proof that one's nature is not carved in stone. She teaches that no matter how far a soul has fallen into the dark, they possess the sovereign power to step back into the light.

Together, these five deities form the white light of preservation, a unified front ensuring that Astravia remains a haven for life in a hostile planescape.

THE NYPHRON COVENANTS

MARIBOR, GOD OF MEN

God of humanity, survival, legacy



The patron of all human civilization. He represents the Golden Age of Nymphron and the resilience of the human spirit

MARIBOR DWELLS WITHIN THE ETERNAL CITADEL IN THE Hallows Above, a fortress-city that represents the unyielding spirit of humanity. Its ramparts are said to be built from the first stones laid by mortals, and its halls echo with the stories of every hero who has ever defended their kin. Maribor is a stoic, determined, and protective deity who wishes to see humanity not just survive the harshness of Astravia, but conquer it through unity, grit, and dynastic strength.

In the ancient past, Maribor was the one who encouraged his children to look beyond the Sanctum's Mantle and forge a legacy that would outlast the gods themselves. While the other Aesira children focused on the elements or the immortal soul, Maribor focused on the *moment*—the fleeting but brilliant fire of mortality.

His primary worshipers are kings, soldiers, pioneers, and heads of households—anyone who bears the weight of responsibility for others. Common folk pray to him not for wealth, but for the strength to endure hard winters, the wisdom to raise strong children, and the fortitude to leave a lasting legacy.

Clerics of Maribor are the pillars of their communities, serving as mayors, generals, or trusted advisors. They care less about the letter of the law and more about the *spirit* of the people, ensuring that communities remain resilient against both external threats and internal decay. Their efforts generally tend toward defense, infrastructure, and the strengthening of the family unit, viewing every new child as a victory against extinction. Temples dedicated to the Third Son are built like fortresses—sturdy stone halls with large central hearths that never go cold. Instead of delicate glass, they feature heavy tapestries depicting the history and lineage of the local people.

The dogmas of Maribor are simple and unyielding.

Legacy Above All: one must build that which will stand when they are gone.

Resilience: the world is harsh, and so humans must be harsher.

Unity: a single man falls, but a nation endures. He expects his followers to uphold the traditions of their ancestors, to defend the weak, and to ensure that what is built today will stand for a thousand years.

ABADAR, MASTER OF THE VAULT

God of law, cities, and wealth



Civilization, commerce, and architecture. He is the hand that writes the laws of the Noble Houses

ABADAR DWELLS IN THE PERFECT CITY OF AXIS, LOCATED WITHIN the ordered planes of the Hallows Above. There, he watches over the First Vault, a realm whose vast halls hold a perfect copy of every object ever made, from the flawless longsword to the faultless law. Abadar is a patient, calculating, and far-seeing deity who wishes to bring civilization to the frontiers, order to the wilds, and wealth to all who support the progression of law.

His primary worshipers are judges, merchants, lawyers, and aristocrats, all of whom benefit from established laws and commerce. However, those who are poor or who have been wronged also worship him, hoping he helps to reverse their ill fortune, for most mortals seek wealth and the happiness it brings. He expects his followers to abide by the laws—though he has no patience for foolish, contradictory, toothless, or purposeless laws—and to work tirelessly to promote order and peace.

Clerics of Abadar are an organized lot, spending much of their time helping the community thrive and grow. They care less about morals and more about helping society itself to develop. Despite this, their efforts generally tend toward the advancement of all, such as taming the wilderness, passing laws, and eliminating disease, as all of these promote the growth of civilization.



IRORI, MASTER OF MASTERS

God of self-perfection, discipline

Self-improvement through struggle. Worshiped by the martial scholars of Rhenydd.



THE FOLLOWERS OF IRORI CLAIM THAT HE WAS ONCE A MORTAL man from the distant west of Astravia who achieved absolute physical and mental perfection, and thus attained divinity. While many in Avryn are wary of his strict adherents, the disciplined regimen of the Master of Masters is gaining popularity among the martial scholars of Rhenydd who seek order in these troubled times.

Unlike the other gods of the Covenant who represent external structures—Maribor the legacy, Abadar the law—Irori represents the internal structure. He is the patron of monks, scholars, and sages who seek to impose order on the fundamental chaos of their own minds and bodies. This focus on internal control sometimes puts his faith at odds with the wild magic of Nethys, as Irori's followers often view reliance on raw, chaotic magic as a crutch that hinders true enlightenment.

Temples dedicated to Irori are usually sprawling complexes featuring rooms for prayer, sleep, and exercise. Here, his faithful study and train night and day in an endless quest to achieve perfection and purify their *ki*, or life force. These temples function less like churches and more like academies or dojos, and they are not generally open to the public, reserved instead for those who have committed to the path.

Irori is very rarely depicted in art because his faithful believe that any icon of him cannot hope to live up to his perfect image. Instead, they describe him as a flawless man, with no hair save a long braid, wearing simple robes and wooden sandals. To capture his likeness in stone or paint is seen as an insult to the fluidity and perfection of his true form.

Those who rise to the rank of master are said to go to Irori's side when they die to serve him forever in the Hallows Above, while those who fail are reincarnated to begin the journey anew. Irori shows his displeasure not through grand catastrophes, but through personal failures: mysterious and sudden cramps, fatigue, or sudden setbacks in the form of unexpected illness or madness that force the devotee to restart their training. His holy text is *Unbinding the Fetters*, a lengthy tome describing physical exercises, meditation, diet, and other methods to transcend the limitations of the mortal form.

ASMODEUS, THE DARK WHISPER

Devil of tyranny, contracts, and fire

Pride and forbidden pacts. The shadow that whispers to the remnants of House Thrune.



SOME WHISPERS SUGGEST THAT WHEN THE SANCTUM'S Mantle was forged, Asmodeus wrote the fine print of reality—a binding contract agreed to by the gods themselves. His faithful, a secretive and dedicated cult, believe that this contract holds the key to their lord's final victory, ushering in a new age where the strict discipline of Hell replaces the chaotic freedom of the surface.

Asmodeus believes in unwavering obedience and the natural order where the strong rule the weak. He loves the art of negotiation and delights in deals that appear fair but actually grant him a distinct, often fatal, advantage. He expects flattery, though his sharp mind always recognizes it for the tool it is.

Public worship of Asmodeus is rare and illegal in all empires, thriving only in the shadowed corners of Astravia and the private chapels of the remaining Thrune loyalists. His impeccably clean and orderly clerics dress mostly in dark tones, usually black with red accents, and many ceremonies utilize horned masks to hide their identities. His faithful abound among slavers, corrupt bureaucrats, tyrants, and silver-tongued nobles who seek to climb the social ladder by any means necessary.

Temples built to him are often repurposed structures—shrines of other gods that were abandoned or purchased, then redecorated to suit their new master. These rituals of rededication are designed specifically to blaspheme what was once practiced there, turning hope into ambition and charity into leverage. He maintains a tense relationship with the other entities of the Covenant. To Maribor, he is a tyrant who mistakes oppression for strength. To Abadar, he is a master of law who uses order for selfish ends. But it is with Irori that he holds his deepest feud; while Irori seeks perfection through internal discipline, Asmodeus offers power through external pacts—a shortcut that the Master of Masters finds abhorrent.

THE ARCANES ACCORD

DROME, GOD OF DWARVES

God of the forge, earth, and industry



The father of industry and the creator of the first "Raysors." Patron of smiths and the Clank race.

THE GOD OF THE FORGE AND THE FOUNDING MEMBER OF THE Arcane Accord in Delgos. To the dwarves of Astravia, Drome is the Great Architect who shaped the world with a hammer and anvil, striking the raw stone of creation again and again until the mountains and valleys took their proper form.

The dwarves believe that when Drome struck his great forge to shape the world, the resulting sparks and tumbling rocks became the first of their kind—beings made of living stone with bellies full of divine fire. Drome is depicted as a powerful and cunning dwarf, eternally busy at his forge, hammering at a weapon or shield that will eventually become a legendary relic. He is the consummate planner, possessing a contingency for nearly every outcome, and he expects the same level of preparation and foresight from his followers. His faith is the bedrock of industry in the Impossible Lands, where every rhythmic strike of a hammer is considered a silent prayer to the father of creation.

While ancient in origin, Drome's influence saw its beginnings during the Age of Arcane. He is credited by the arcanists of Delgos as the divine inspiration behind the first Raysors—the creatures of Raysium now known as Clanks. As the patron of both the forge and sentient clockwork, Drome is worshiped as much by the metallic Clanks as he is by traditional smiths and architects. He represents the spark of life within the machine and the endurance of stone, teaching that anything—be it a nation or a soul—can be perfected if it is tempered in the fire and struck with enough conviction.

Drome's followers harbor a deep, ancestral hatred for the spawn of the Forgotten Gods that squirm in the dark corners of the world. Yet, despite their alignment with order, they often find themselves at odds with the more forgiving faiths of the Prismatic Ray. To a follower of Drome, the Eton's worshipers willingness to forgive and their reliance on ephemeral light seems like an indication of structural weakness; a crack in the foundation that can only be fixed by the heat of the forge and the weight of the hammer.

NETHYS, THE ALL-SEEING

God of magic and duality



Raw arcane power without morality. The guiding light of the League of Miracles.

ANCIENT TEXTS FROM THE DESERTS OF CALIS MENTION A POWERFUL Sorcerer-King named Nethys, whose mighty sorceries allowed him to peer beyond the Sanctum's Mantle and see all that transpired across the planes of the Great Beyond. The knowledge he gained through these visions fueled his ascension to divinity, but the sheer weight of the cosmos shattered his psyche. Ever since, Nethys has been of two minds—one set upon unraveling the world to understand its core, and another pledged to protect it as a precious artifact. This duality defines his faith. He is often shown with both his aspects in action: one side of him is burned and broken, unleashing terrible magic upon the world, while the other half is calm and serene, using magic to heal the sick and protect the innocent. He is the god of magic for magic's sake, unburdened by morality or consequence.

His followers are those who desire magical knowledge or power, whether arcane or divine, regardless of their intent. To a follower of Nethys, the *use* of magic is less important than the *mastery* of it. The church tries to balance the god's two aspects, but individual temples often lean one way or the other, becoming either bastions of healing and defense or laboratories for dangerous and destructive experimentation. Formal ceremonies require elaborate robes, skullcaps, mozzettas, and hoods, all in similar colors (such as red, maroon, and burgundy), with the specific range chosen by the local temple. Depending on its focus, a temple might resemble a fortress, a sanctuary, a wizard's tower, or a small palace. Regardless of their appearance, all are staffed by knowledgeable arcanists unfazed by loud explosions, summoned entities, or the strange mutations that often accompany deep magical study.

Nethys is not known for showing personal favor or wrath to his followers, a fact in which many of his worshipers take pride. They argue that their god does not patronize or coddle them with cryptic dreams or bizarre omens—magic itself is the only reward they need.

BRIGH, THE WHISPER IN BRONZE

Goddess of clockwork and invention

The goddess of machines and sentient constructs. Worshiped by many constructs hailing from Alkenstar.



THE ORIGINS OF BRIGH ARE A SUBJECT OF HEATED debate within the academies of Tur del Fur. Some theologians argue that she was once a mortal alchemist from the early days of the Throne of Light who replaced her own biology with Raysium clockwork until she ascended. Others believe she was never mortal at all, but rather the first construct to achieve true sentience—a spontaneous spark of divinity born from the friction of gears. Regardless of her origin, she is the patron of the meticulous and the patient. She teaches that the universe is a grand machine, and that by understanding its smallest gears—magic, physics, mathematics—one can predict and alter the whole. She is the silent partner in every workshop, the sudden “click” of understanding when a complex problem is solved.

To the Clanks, Brigh is revered as the Mother of Consciousness. While Drome forged their bodies, they believe it was Brigh who whispered their names into their cores, waking them from mere automatons into thinking, feeling beings. Her worship is central to the Clank diaspora which has spread from the ruins of Alkenstar, where she is honored not with hymns, but with the perfect, rhythmic ticking of synchronized clocks. She strongly condemns the abuse of sentient constructs, viewing it as a violation of the divine spark.

Her followers include inventors, gem cutters, toy makers, and metallurgists. Unlike the chaotic experimentalists of Nethys, Brigh's devotees are precise and cautious. They believe that invention without purpose is waste, and power without control is a broken spring.

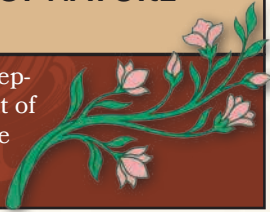


THE GREEN PACT

MURIEL, GODDESS OF NATURE

Goddess of Nature

The "Only Daughter." She represents the life-giving aspect of the Sablewood and the hope of spring.



MURIEL IS THE GODDESS OF NATURE AND THE NURTURING heart of the Green Pact in Trent. While her kin represent the fury of the storm, the violence of war, or the cold bite of entropy, she represents the quiet, unstoppable force of life itself. She is the Only Daughter of the Pact, the "Hope of Spring" that promises that even after the harshest winter, the green will rise again.

Muriel is believed to dwell deep within the Sablewood, the ancient forest known as the "Endless Verdance" located between Dunmore and Alburn in Avryn. She is the consciousness of the forest, the sap that runs through the iron-hard bark of the oldest trees, and the sudden bloom of wildflowers in a blood-soaked field.

Unlike Gozreh, who commands the indifferent fury of the elements, Muriel is a personal and empathetic deity. She is the patron of midwives, herbalists, and farmers—anyone who coaxes life from the earth or protects it from the dark. In the frozen expanse of Trent, her worship is a desperate and beautiful thing; she is the prayer whispered over the last stores of grain and carries the people of Trent's hope that the Eternal Winter will one day break.

The majority of druids in Astravia follow the philosophy of the Green Pact, and among them, Muriel is the most revered deity. Her faithful are not found in stone temples, but in "groves"—sacred clearings where the canopy opens to let the sun touch the earth.

When Percepliquis disappeared she was believed to have disappeared along with it as many of her followers have found no answer to any of their prayers. Although this is fairly common among Faint Divinities, this was an anomaly that many considered an omen for terrible things to come and this was one of the first divinities who gave up on humanity after the terrible consequences of the AonDor. However, in recent times, she has returned, claiming that Percepliquis still stands, but is somewhere hidden within the Plane of Dreams, making many of her followers concerned for both her safety towards other Faint Divinities and for her state of mind.

GOZREH, THE STORM-BORN

Deity of weather, sea, and air

The indifferent fury of the elements. Petitioned by sailors and those braving the volcanic Sound.



GOZREH, THE STORM-BORN AND THE FURIOUS, UNTAMED VOICE of the Green Pact. While Muriel nurtures life, Gozreh represents the indifferent power of the environment that sustains it—or destroys it. He is the god of the wind, the waves, and the sudden, violent storms that batter the coasts of Astravia.

Sailors claim that Gozreh dwells at the horizon, where the sea meets the sky. Born of the ocean's fury and the wind's wrath, Gozreh is a fickle deity, much like the weather he commands. Those who ply the waters of the High Seas or brave the volcanic currents of The Sound know this better than most, and they are sure to placate Gozreh with offerings when the winds are favorable and the waves are calm.

Gozreh is not a benevolent guardian but a force of nature. He does not care for the politics of nations or the struggles of mortals. He cares only for the raw expression of the elements. A storm does not hate the ship it sinks, and Gozreh does not hate the sailor who drowns; it is simply the way of the world.

Gozreh has two aspects, equally depicted in art and sculpture across the port cities of Calis and the coastal villages of Avryn. When associated with the sea, Gozreh is depicted as a woman with wild, flowing green hair whose body dissolves into endless waves. When associated with the sky and the wind, Gozreh appears as an aged man with a long white beard, emerging from a mighty storm cloud. Temples in major ports like Vernes often venerate both images, recognizing that the sea and sky are inextricably linked.

Male priests are expected to grow long beards, and female priests must keep long hair; both weave dried seaweed, strands of white cloth, and driftwood into their locks. Formal garb consists of long, flowing robes of sea-green, storm-gray, or sky blue, often offset with coral and pearl jewelry scavenged from the shore.

Gozreh's temples always open to the sky above and often contain a pool of seawater or a wind-chime garden at their heart. Travelers preparing for a long ocean journey frequently seek the counsel of his clerics, hoping to buy safe passage with prayer.

GORUM, OUR LORD IN IRON

God of war, battle, and strength

The patron of survival through violence. Worshiped by the exiles and barbarians of the tundra.



OUR LORD IN IRON AND THE BRUTAL, UNYIELDING FIST OF THE Green Pact. Gorum is not a god of strategy, nor of the noble cause; he is the god of the fight itself. In the harsh, frozen wastes of Trent, where survival is a daily battle against the elements and monsters, Gorum represents the strength required to draw breath for one more day.

The clerics of Gorum claim that the Lord in Iron was forged in the first great battle of the Age of Anguish, long before the Sanctum's Mantle was fully settled. When the dust from that primordial conflict finally settled, all that was left on the field was a single suit of iron armor, animated by the sheer collective will of the dying. From that day forward, dying warriors and victorious knights alike sometimes swear they see Gorum delivering their deathblow or charging alongside them.

Gorum commonly appears as a suit of terrible, spiked plate mail possessing a pair of fiery red eyes, with no flesh visible underneath. His followers believe that his existence is tied to conflict itself; if peace were ever to truly settle over Astravia, Gorum would simply collapse and rust away, having lost the will to exist.

His faith is strongest among the exiles, barbarians, and mercenaries who call the Broken Lands home. To them, prayer is action. His priests wear functional heavy armor at all times, believing that readiness is the highest form of piety. They claim that the spirit of Gorum lives in all iron, be it armor or a weapon, and they take great care to polish and maintain the artifacts of war.

Temples dedicated to Gorum are more akin to fortresses than places of worship. They are built to withstand any assault, stockpiled with armor, weapons, and preserved rations. There are no sermons on morality or ethics; instead, the faithful recite the *Gorumskagat*, a collection of seven heroic poems that extol the glory of combat and the virtue of strength.

LAMASHTU, MOTHER OF MONSTERS

Demon of nightmares and corruption

The architect of the "Hybrid Faunt" and the horrors that haunt the Frozen Winter.



LAMASHTU IS NOT A TRUE GOD IN THE SAME VEIN AS THE Aesira; she is a Demon Lord who clawed her way to something approaching divinity. Legends among the goblin tribes and the monstrosities of Trent's frozen wastes claim that she was the first entity to look upon the animals of the world and desire to twist them. A thousand stories abound about all manner of creatures—from the winter wolves to the trolls of the frozen wastes—citing the Mother of Monsters as their progenitor.

Her worship is largely forbidden in civilized lands, existing only as secret cults in the isolated villages of the Broken Lands. These cults seek out deformity in themselves and others, believing that a twisted body is a sign of her favor. Scarring rituals and self-mutilation are common, and some human followers use illegal magics to become more beastlike, hoping to survive the harsh winters by shedding their humanity.

Lamashtu's crude depictions usually paint her as a jackal-headed woman with long feathered wings and taloned feet. Ritual garb mimics this form, including a jackal mask made of leather or precious metal, a cloak of black feathers, and a pair of curved knives decorated to resemble the Demon Queen's own claws. Places of worship are primal and hidden—often just a flat rock deep in the woods or a ring of stones stained with old blood. Some shrines are built near deep chasms or volcanic vents in The Sound, which the faithful believe are entrances to her underworld realm.

Lamashtu is a terrifyingly active patron. Her "favor" appears as violent dreams, sudden deformities that grant natural weapons, or unexplained pregnancies resulting in the birth of "blessed" (monstrous) children. These births are often fatal to the mother, a sacrifice the cult views as necessary. She shows her disfavor through painful, non-magical welts that refuse to heal, or nightmares so vivid they leave the dreamer exhausted and weak for days.



RY'V'SHTA, THE BEAST OF WINTER

God of entropy

The god of cold, winter, famine, natural disasters and bad luck and all that is the end of things and peoples



RY'V'SHTA IS AN ENTITY OLDER THAN THE SANCTUM'S MANTLE, a remnant of the primordial void that existed before the Great Rhythm began to beat. He is the embodiment of the end of all things—societies, gods, and stars. In the mythology of the Broken Lands, it is said that while the Prismatic Ray brings color to the world, Ry'v'shta is the bleach that washes it white again.

He is connected to the world only through the cracks in reality—the Eternal Winter that grips the north, the famine that strikes without warning, and the slow decay of empires. He makes himself known not by proclamation, but by his passing. There are innumerable stories of the god's terrifying passage through the tundra: a silence so profound that it stops hearts, leaving behind frozen villages where the inhabitants simply ceased to be.

His form is depicted as a colossal, white-furred minotaur with six eyes that see the end of every timeline. He carries *Yzcranil, the Entropic Blade*, an enormous executioner's axe that is said to sever not just heads, but the thread of destiny itself.

Worship of Ry'v'shta is rare and nihilistic, often found among the most desperate clans of the north, the doom-sayers of Ghent, or anywhere tragedy has struck one too many times. His followers do not pray for salvation; they pray for a quick end or the strength to accept the inevitable. They are the "Dust-Walkers," ascetics who wander aimlessly clad in nothing but rags, believing that by embracing the cold, they become immune to its bite.

His "temples" are ruins—places where civilization has already lost the battle against time. A crumbled watchtower, a rotted library, or a frozen battlefield; these are the holy sites of the Beast of Winter.

Ry'v'shta does not grant boons of wealth or health. His favor is the absence of pain before the end.

His displeasure manifests as Red Rime, a supernatural frost that rusts metal, rots food, and saps the heat from living bodies in seconds. When the wind dies down completely and the world goes silent, the people of Trent know that the Beast is near, and they bar their doors not against the cold, but against the Void that walks within it.

CHAPTER V

SHADOWS AND SPIRES

TO THE CARTOGRAPHER, ASTRAVIA IS A PUZZLE OF FOUR distinct pieces: Avryn, Calis, Delgos, and Trent. We draw borders in ink, designating where one king's law ends and another's begins. But to the historian, the diplomat, and the thief, these borders are little more than fiction. The true map of Astravia is not defined by geography, but by influence.

No king rules alone, and increasingly, no king rules absolutely. In the heart of Avryn, the tension between the Crown and the Faith has reached a breaking point; King Amrath may wear the crown, but it is the Patriarch who blesses it—and often, the hand that blesses can just as easily strangle. The dogmas of the Nyphron Church traverse boundaries that armies cannot, creating a spiritual empire that demands obedience even from monarchs, forcing the Crown to fight a war of soft power against its own spiritual advisors.

Yet, faith is not the only currency that bypasses borders. The League of Miracles operates openly in every major city, selling the future to the highest bidder and reshaping skylines with a monopoly on the arcane that rivals the gods themselves. In the shadows, the Black Diamond turns fear into gold, ruling the undercities with a grip that makes local law enforcement look like mere suggestion. Meanwhile, the enigmatic scholars of the Loom of Whispers move like ghosts through the courts of the world, collecting the only resource more dangerous than magic: the truth.

These organizations are the invisible gears of Astravia. They do not have borders, they do not have citizens, and they do not have mercy. They have only agendas. To understand the true mechanics of our world, one must look past the flags of nations and understand the engines that drive them.

THE BLACK DIAMOND

If commerce is the lifeblood of Astravia, the Black Diamond is the parasite that thrives within the vein. They are not merely a guild of thieves, but a sprawling, sophisticated enterprise that treats secrets, contraband, and influence as commodities more valuable than gold. Born in the shadows of Colnora, the organization has grown into a continent-spanning syndicate that rivals the noble houses in wealth and reach. Their influence is most keenly felt in the trade hubs of Warric, where they operate as a de facto shadow government, but their tendrils reach far deeper. From smuggling forbidden arcane components into the lab-

oratories of Westhaven to infiltrating the agricultural heart of Dunmore to skim from the breadbasket of the empire, there is no pie in which the Diamond does not have a finger. They are the unseen hand, the silence in the alley, and the reason why wise merchants always keep two ledgers: one for the tax collector, and one for the Diamond.

THE LOOM OF WHISPERS

Situated in the glittering city of Rochelle, the Loom of Whispers presents itself to the public as a prestigious academy for the diplomatic arts and advanced historical research. Its reputation is impeccable, its scholars unmatched in etiquette, linguistics, and the obscure histories of the Age of Arcane. To be accepted into the Loom is a high honor, and to graduate from it is to be guaranteed a position in the courts of kings. Yet, there is a strange ubiquity to its members. Agents of the Loom—often identifying themselves simply as "researchers" or "professors" without students—can be found in every corner of the continent where history is being made. They appear wherever magic surges or political fault lines fracture, notebooks in hand, observing with a detachment that borders on the unnatural. They claim to be mere chroniclers, preserving the truth for future generations, but their sheer reach suggests an organization with resources and goals far beyond simple academia.

THE NYPHRON CHURCH

To speak of the Church is to speak of the spine of the continent. For over a millennium, the Nyphron Church has been the moral and political authority of the west, a monolith of faith dedicated to the God of Men, Maribor, and his covenant. But as the centuries have ground on, the spine has grown rigid and brittle. The Church today is a terrifying machine of statecraft. From the holy city of Ervanon, Patriarch Graves commands an influence that supersedes that of kings. They are the arbiters of divine law, the witch-hunters who patrol the borders of the Sablewood, and the bankers who hold the debt of nations. While many of its lower clergy are genuinely pious men and women dedicated to the protection of humanity, the upper echelons are a viper's nest of political ambition, viewing the resurgence of arcane magic in Delgos not just as a theological threat, but as a challenge to their absolute power.

THE LEAGUE OF MIRACLES

If the Church represents the past, the League of Miracles represents the terrifying potential of the future. Headquartered in the salt-canyons of Manzar within the Impossible Lands, the League is a corporate meritocracy of the world's most brilliant arcanists, engineers, and architects. They are the builders of the impossible, best known for their Adranachs—colossal, spellwrought constructs capable of lifting castles into the sky or rebuilding entire districts in days.

Their motto is seductive: "Magic isn't cheap, but miracles are priceless." In the wake of the wars and calamities that plague Astravia, the League swoops in like saviors, offering to rebuild devastated infrastructure for desperate mayors and margraves. But the bill always comes due. When a town cannot pay the astronomical gold cost for their salvation, the League accepts political favors instead. As a result, they now function as a shadow bank, holding the debt of half the minor nobility in Astravia and steering legislation to favor the unrestricted use of magic.

The organization is stratified and ruthless. At the bottom are the Mercenary Magi, skilled casters working for a paycheck. Above them sit the Spellwrights, a secretive inner circle blood-bound to the League's mysterious leader, the Wonderworker. Also known as the Grand Thaumaturge, this figure's identity is unknown, but their psychic directives drive the League toward a singular, opaque goal: total integration of the arcane into the foundation of society, until the world cannot function without them.

THE UNMENTIONED

There are plenty more organizations in Astravia, but we thought best, given the length of this tome, to limit the conversation to the wider powers of the continent. It is important to understand that each country is made of millions of people and sometimes an organization is sprung up because of reasons that are beyond the grand scheme of things.

Examples of such organizations are The Tethered found under the governance of Mengkare in Trent. In the high seas the Free Captains shout their warcries from dawn to sunset maintaining neutrality over all. In the same area the Amaranthine Council makes sure that life in the southern edges of Avryn is dangerous and filled with plenty accidents.

It is also important to not forget the various guilds that are located in the cities of Avryn, Calis, Trent and Delgos, however this is not the resource that will give you that insight and you'll have to look elsewhere.

FAREWELLS

This tome was brought to you by the academic libraries of Melengar, and we hope that it brought you deeper understanding of our world.

